English Book I (Short Stories) — Class 11 — Solved Exercises (PCTB)

Lesson 1: Button, Button (Richard Matheson)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 8)

(i) Where did Norma put the lamb chops?

(a) in the oven

✓ (b) in the broiler

(c) in the freezer

(d) in the basket

(ii) There was a small man:

(a) in the porch

(b) in the room

✓ (c) at the door

(d) in the hallway

(iii) Where was the key to the bell-unit dome?

(a) in the box

(b) in the drawer

✓ (c) in the sealed envelope

(d) in the pocket

(iv) What was the reward for pushing the button?

(a) $25,000

✓ (b) $50,000

(c) $5,000

(d) $500

(v) Which question of Norma embarrassed Mr. Steward?

(a) Where do you live?

(b) How do you do?

✓ (c) What do you sell?

(d) Who do you represent?

(vi) What could have happened by pushing the button?

(a) a door would open

(b) a person would be born

(c) a person would lose his job

✓ (d) somewhere in the world some unknown person would die

(vii) Why did Arthur not agree with Norma?

(a) he did not believe Mr. Steward

(b) he felt that the money would not be paid

✓ (c) he considered death of some unknown person a murder

(d) he thought his wife was mad

(viii) Why was $50,000 attractive for Norma?

✓ (a) she had a plan to improve her life

(b) she felt no harm in psychological research

(c) she wanted jewellery

(d) she wanted a new house

(ix) Who, in Norma's opinion, was the researcher?

(a) a psychiatrist

✓ (b) an eccentric millionaire

(c) a doctor

(d) a murderer

(x) Why did Norma not take her husband's consent?

(a) she thought her husband would agree

(b) she was angry with her husband

(c) she thought he would not understand

✓ (d) he considered it immoral to kill some unknown person for money

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 8)

(i) Norma found the carton in front of her door as she arrived home. [True]

(ii) Norma believed that Mr. Steward was a guest. [False]

(iii) Mr. Steward took out a key and opened the box for Arthur. [False]

(iv) Arthur and Norma have the same reaction to Mr. Steward's proposition. [False]

(v) Norma could not resist calling Mr. Steward back. [True]

(vi) Norma did not agree with Mr. Steward to have the button unit

brought back. [True]

(vii) Arthur said he believed that Mr. Steward's offer was a genuine one. [False]

(viii) Norma wants Arthur to understand that she is interested in the proposition because the money would help the two of them. [True]

(ix) Arthur could accept participating along with Norma if they were part of a research project. [False]

(x) Norma called Mr. Steward after she learned of Arthur's death. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 9)

(i) Why did Norma consider Mr. Steward's tone and attitude offensive?

Mr. Steward spoke in a superior and commanding tone and insisted on talking even when Norma said she was busy. His pushy manner and his remark that she did not want to know what he was selling offended her sense of dignity.

(ii) Why did Arthur disagree with his wife?

Arthur disagreed because he believed that pushing the button would be murder. Killing an unknown person, even a stranger far away, only for money was immoral in his eyes, and no amount of money could justify it.

(iii) Why did Norma try to persuade her husband to agree with her?

Norma tried to persuade Arthur because the fifty thousand dollars would improve their life. She dreamed of a trip to Europe, a cottage on the Island, a nicer apartment, better furniture, clothes and a car, all of which seemed within reach.

(iv) What reasons did Norma give her husband to accept the offer?

Norma argued that the person who died would be someone they had never seen, perhaps a Chinese peasant or a native in the Congo, so they would never know about it. She also said it was probably only a psychological research project meant to study people's reactions.

(v) Why did Mr. Steward continue persuading Norma?

Mr. Steward continued persuading Norma because it was his work as an agent of an international organization. He had to get her to accept the button unit and push the button, so he kept pressing her with arguments until she agreed.

(vi) What was the message Norma received on pushing the button?

After pushing the button, Norma received a telephone call from the Lenox Hill Hospital. The caller informed her that Arthur had been pushed from the platform in front of a train in a subway accident and had died.

(vii) What is the significance of Arthur's life-insurance policy in the story?

Arthur had a life-insurance policy for $25,000 with double indemnity, which meant Norma would receive $50,000 on his death. This is exactly the amount Mr. Steward had offered, so the price of pushing the button turned out to be her own husband's life.

(viii) Did Norma remain normal on hearing the news of her husband's accident?

No, Norma did not remain normal. She was shocked and trembling, she could hardly breathe, she walked numbly into the kitchen, smashed the button unit in fury, and shrieked at Mr. Steward on the telephone.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 9)

(i) Write a note on the character of Arthur.

Arthur Lewis is an honest and morally upright man. He works hard, lives a simple life with his wife, and refuses to be tempted by easy money. When Mr. Steward offers fifty thousand dollars for pushing a button that will kill an unknown person, Arthur at once calls it murder and rejects the offer. He is not greedy and he judges every act by its moral value, not by its profit. He is also a loving husband who tries to reason with Norma instead of quarrelling with her. His death in the end is the tragic price of his wife's weakness, and it proves that his moral stand was right.

(ii) Why did Norma not remain true to her husband?

Norma did not remain true to her husband because greed overcame her love and loyalty. She was tempted by the dream of a better life: a trip to Europe, a cottage on the Island and a nicer home. She convinced herself that the death of an unknown stranger did not matter and that the offer might only be a research project. Behind her husband's back she took the button unit from the cabinet and pressed the button. Her disloyalty was not hatred but weakness before temptation, and it destroyed the very

person she claimed to love.

(iii) Do you agree with Norma's assertion that the death of someone you have never seen is not important?

No, I do not agree with Norma. A human life has the same value whether the person is known to us or not, near or far. Killing a stranger for money is still murder, and distance does not lessen the crime. Norma's argument was only an excuse to hide her greed from herself. The story proves her wrong in a terrible way: the unknown person who died was her own husband. This shows that every life matters and that no one has the right to trade a life for money.

(iv) Write the story in your own words.

Mr. Steward, an agent of an international organization, leaves a button unit with Norma Lewis and offers her fifty thousand dollars if she pushes the button, warning that some unknown person in the world will die. Her husband Arthur calls the offer murder and refuses it. Tempted by dreams of Europe and a cottage, Norma secretly presses the button after Arthur leaves for work. Soon she receives a call from the hospital: Arthur has been pushed from a platform in front of a train and killed. When Mr. Steward telephones, she cries that she was told she would not know the one who died, and he replies with the chilling question whether she really thought she knew her husband.

(v) What moral lesson do you get from the story?

The story teaches that greed destroys happiness and that no amount of money is worth a human life. Norma wanted a better life but lost her husband, the most precious part of her life. It also teaches that moral

principles must not be bent by excuses: calling murder a research project does not change its nature. Finally, it warns that every action has a hidden price. The fifty thousand dollars Norma desired came to her through her husband's insurance, but the cost was guilt and loss that no money could ever repair.

Exercise 5: Connect part of Column I with the relevant part of Column II (Book p. 9)

She sat down to open —
the package.

She saw a folded piece of paper —
scotch-taped to the bottom of the box.

Arthur came out of —
the living room.

It won't take long —
to explain.

The offer is completely —
genuine.

The organization is of —
international scope.

Are you sure you wouldn't —

care to think about it for a day or so?

He placed it on the table —

by the door.

He looked at her reflection —

in the bathroom mirror.

She took the card halves —

from her purse.

Exercise 6: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 10)

(i) He (unlock) the dome and (go) to the door.

He unlocked the dome and went to the door.

(ii) She (turn) the card over.

She turned the card over.

(iii) She (reread) the card.

She reread the card.

(iv) He (remove) his hat and (open) the box.

He removed his hat and opened the box.

(v) She (look) at the button.

She looked at the button.

Exercise 7: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 10)

mr steward looked embarrassed im afraid im not at liberty to tell you that he said however i assure you the organization is of international scope

"Mr. Steward looked embarrassed. 'I'm afraid I'm not at liberty to tell you that,' he said. 'However, I assure you the organization is of international scope.'"

Exercise 8: Change into indirect narration (Book p. 10)

(i) The salesman said to the customer, "Don't you want to know about it?"

The salesman asked the customer if she did not want to know about it.

(ii) Asif said to his friend, "I hope everything goes well with you."

Asif told his friend that he hoped everything went well with him.

(iii) The lawyer said to his client, "Where shall we meet tomorrow, at my home or at yours?"

The lawyer asked his client where they should meet the next day, at his home or at his client's.

(iv) The father said, "All is well that ends well." He had finished the story.

The father said that all was well that ended well when he had finished

the story.

Lesson 2: Clearing in the Sky (Jesse Stuart)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 15)

(i) The old man wanted to show his son:

(a) his old house

(b) his new tractor

✓ (c) a patch of clearing

(d) a herd of cattle

(ii) The day was:

✓ (a) hot

(b) cold

(c) rainy

(d) cloudy

(iii) How many years ago did the doctor advise the old man to take rest?

(a) ten

(b) twenty

(c) thirty

✓ (d) forty

(iv) How many children had the old man?

(a) three

(b) four

✓ (c) five

(d) seven

(v) What did the old man cut with his pocket knife?

(a) a sapling

(b) a flower

✓ (c) a wisp of alfalfa

(d) a tomato

(vi) In how many years did the old man improve the land?

(a) twenty

✓ (b) thirty

(c) forty

(d) sixty

(vii) Why did they hunt squirrels?

(a) to sell them

(b) to keep them as pets

✓ (c) to cook for a meal

(d) to protect the crops

(viii) What special tree did the old man find in the woods?

(a) a cherry tree

(b) an apple tree

(c) an orange tree

✓ (d) a coffee tree

(ix) The clearing was not more than:

(a) three acres

(b) four acres

(c) two acres

✓ (d) three-fourth of an acre

(x) The land was fenced by:

(a) the son

(b) the neighbours

✓ (c) the old man

(d) the doctor

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 15)

(i) Jess's father was a weak man. [False]

(ii) The old man followed his doctors' advice all his life. [False]

(iii) The old man invited his son to take a walk up a mountain path. [True]

(iv) When the old man reached seventy, he wanted to go back to farming land that had never been touched. [True]

(v) Thirty years' labour of the old man proved futile. [False]

(vi) The old man took the easy path to go to the top. [False]

(vii) The old man took rest twice while climbing the steep bluff. [True]

(viii) The old man did not have trust in God. [False]

(ix) The old man felt relieved on seeing the fruit of his toil. [True]

(x) The vegetables were better flavoured because of sunshine in the clearing. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions in one or two sentences (Book p. 16)

(i) Why did the old man not follow his doctors' advice?

The old man did not follow his doctors' advice because he loved work and the land. He believed that working kept him alive, and he refused to sit idle and wait for death.

(ii) What had the doctors told the old man?

The doctors had told the old man that he had a weak heart and must be careful. They advised him not to work on the farm and warned him that he had not long to live.

(iii) Where did the old man take his son?

The old man took his son up the mountain path to the top of the mountain, where he had made a secret clearing and a small garden in the heart of the wilderness.

(iv) Had the son ever been to that place before?

No, the son had never seen the clearing before, although he had been over that high point of rugged land many times in the past.

(v) What are the names of the vegetables grown by the old man?

In his secret clearing the old man grew tomatoes, yams and potatoes, in rows on the mountain top. In his earlier days he and his wife had also raised corn, beans and pumpkins on the mountain slope.

(vi) Why did the old man take the steep path to the top?

The old man took the steep path because he had made paths of increasing steepness as his health improved. Climbing the steep path was his own way of knowing that he was getting better all the time.

(vii) Why did the son at the age of six cry?

When the son was six years old, his father took him to the field to thin corn, and the boy lost his little wooden plough in a furrow. He cried and cried until his father made him another plough.

(viii) What were the feelings of the old man at the age of seventy?

At seventy, the old man felt proud, happy and relieved. He had reached three score years and ten, cheated death many times, and wanted to show his son the fruit of his life's work before his time ran out.

(ix) Why had the old man planted the secret garden?

The old man had planted the secret garden to prove that hard work and faith could conquer even a weak heart and worn-out land. It was also a return to his youth, a place of rich new soil where vegetables had a

better flavour, and a gift of memory for his son.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 16)

(i) Describe the physical appearance of the old man.

The old man was seventy years old, with a wrinkled, red face and pale blue eyes. He walked with a cane and wiped the sweat from his face with a big blue bandanna. Although doctors had told him for forty years that he had a weak heart, he was still strong and hard-working. He climbed the steep mountain path, rested only twice, and worked like a man half his age. His body showed a lifetime of labour, but his spirit was unbroken.

(ii) How did the old man feel about the land?

The old man loved the land deeply. He believed that new, untouched soil was the real land that God had left, and he loved its smell and touch. He had spent thirty years improving worn-out acres, and he returned to the mountain top because he wanted to smell the rich loam again and taste vegetables grown in it. For him the land was not just a source of food; it was life itself, and working on it had kept him alive against the doctors' warnings.

(iii) What did the son remember from his childhood? Were these good memories?

The son remembered hunting squirrels with his father in the woods, sitting beneath the hickory trees, and hearing the hickory leaves fall like yellow rain. He also remembered losing his little wooden plough in a

furrow at the age of six and crying until his father made him another. These were good memories, full of love and warmth, and that is why the mountain and the old days remained so dear to him.

(iv) Write the story in your own words.

On a hot day, an old man of seventy takes his son Jess up a steep mountain path to show him something he has never seen. Doctors have told him for forty years that his weak heart will kill him, but he has ignored them and worked hard all his life. On the mountain top he shows his son a small clearing of less than an acre, fenced by his own hands, where he grows tomatoes, yams and potatoes in rich new soil. He explains that he made steeper and steeper paths as his health improved, and that this land is a return to his youth, when he and his wife first farmed the mountain together.

(v) What moral lesson do you get from the story?

The story teaches that determination and love of work can defeat even the warnings of doctors and the weakness of the body. The old man lived to seventy not by resting, as the doctors advised, but by working with faith and joy. It also teaches respect for parents and for the land: the son learns that his father's secret garden is the fruit of thirty years of labour. Finally, it shows that a meaningful life comes from doing what one loves, not from giving up in fear.

Exercise 5: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 17)

(i) He (carry) a basket of dishes to his mother.

He carried a basket of dishes to his mother.

(ii) He (know) how hot it was.

He knew how hot it was.

(iii) He (follow) his father up the path.

He followed his father up the path.

(iv) He (buy) the farm many years ago.

He bought the farm many years ago.

(v) He (want) to show his son the clearing.

He wanted to show his son the clearing.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 17)

now youre coming to something son he said as he pushed down the top wire so that he could cross the fence this is something i want you to see

"Now you're coming to something, son," he said as he pushed down the top wire so that he could cross the fence. "This is something I want you to see."

Lesson 3: Dark They Were, and Golden-Eyed (Ray Bradbury)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 23)

(i) The man felt his hair flutter and the tissues of his body draw tight as if he were:

(a) in a storm

(b) in a desert

(c) on a mountain

✓ (d) standing at the center of a vacuum

(ii) At any moment the Martian air might:

(a) choke him

✓ (b) draw his soul from him

(c) freeze him

(d) blind him

(iii) What did they see on the Martian hills?

✓ (a) the old cities

(b) flower beds

(c) a stream of fresh water

(d) a deep valley

(iv) What did they do after building a cottage?

(a) decorated it

✓ (b) furnished it

(c) ate good breakfasts

(d) arranged a feast

(v) What was the news Laura told her parents?

✓ (a) the war on Earth

(b) the death of the people

(c) the arrival of a rocket

(d) the fall of a rocket

(vi) Which city was attacked by atom bombs?

(a) Texas

(b) Virginia

✓ (c) New York

(d) New Jersey

(vii) What did they feel on Mars after the attack on Earth?

(a) drenched

✓ (b) stranded

(c) secluded

(d) surrendered

(viii) What were the men doing in the town on the shadowy step of the grocery store?

(a) playing cards

✓ (b) conversing with great leisure and ease

(c) waiting for the rocket

(d) selling goods

(ix) How many dollars did Sam demand to sell the metal?

(a) 200

(b) 300

(c) 400

✓ (d) 500

(x) In which season did Mr. Bittering stand very golden-eyed?

(a) winter

(b) summer

✓ (c) autumn

(d) spring

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 23)

(i) The rocket metal burned in the meadow winds. [False]

(ii) He felt submerged in a chemical that could enhance his intellect. [False]

(iii) He felt like a salt crystal in a mountain stream. [True]

(iv) All the space rockets flew up. [False]

(v) He was drenched in the hotness of his fear. [True]

(vi) Harry suggested to build a rocket. [True]

(vii) Men helped Harry in building a rocket. [True]

(viii) The daughter wove tapestries. [True]

(ix) Harry seemed almost as young as his eldest son. [True]

(x) Six years later a rocket fell out of the sky. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 24)

(i) Why did Harry want to go back to Earth?

Harry wanted to go back to Earth because Mars was changing him and his family. He felt that the Martian air, water and food were dissolving his Earth identity, and he feared that if they stayed they would lose themselves completely.

(ii) Why did he want to stay on Mars in the end?

In the end Harry wanted to stay because there was no way back: the rockets had blown up and the town was empty. Mars had gradually become home, his family was content and golden-eyed, and he accepted the new life with calm.

(iii) What sort of climate did they face on Mars?

On Mars they faced a strange climate: a thin air that seemed to dissolve the body, hot summers that burned the canals dry and moved like flame upon the meadows, and cold, foggy nights. The wind blew without rest and the seasons changed the family along with the land.

(iv) What was the condition of the Bittering family on hearing the news of the war on Earth?

On hearing the news of the war, the family was shocked and terrified. Laura wept that they were stranded on Mars forever, and Harry was drenched in the hotness of his fear, for he knew they could never return to Earth.

(v) What did they want to grow on Mars?

They wanted to grow crops and raise children on Mars. Harry told his family to go about their business, raise crops and children, and wait until the war ended and the rockets came again.

(vi) What was the condition of their house on Mars?

Their house was no longer an Earthman's house. The wind had done something to it, the air had burned it, the fog at night had warped its boards out of shape, and it had changed just as its owners were changing.

(vii) What was the advice Harry gave to the people?

Harry warned the people that if they stayed on Mars they would all change, because there was something in the air, a Martian virus, seed or pollen. He urged them to work with him and build a rocket so that they could leave before the change was complete.

(viii) How dangerous can a Martian virus be?

A Martian virus can be extremely dangerous because it changes a person completely and silently. It darkens the skin, turns the eyes golden, alters the body and the mind, and in the end turns Earth people into Martians

who forget their old home altogether.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 24)

(i) What were the circumstances the Bittering family had to face on Mars?

The Bittering family landed on Mars as emigrants escaping the threat of war on Earth. From the first day the thin Martian air made Harry feel that his identity was being dissolved, and the family lived in fear of the change. They built a cottage and tried to live normally, but the air, water and food slowly altered them. Then came the news that atom bombs had hit New York and all the space rockets had blown up, leaving them stranded forever. Their house warped, their eyes turned golden, and by autumn they had become Martians in all but memory.

(ii) How social were the people of Mars?

The people of the Martian town were quiet and easy-going. The men sat on the shadowy step of the grocery store conversing with great leisure and ease, and they laughed gently at Harry's fears. They did not hurry or worry, and they accepted the change without struggle. When Harry asked for help to build a rocket, Sam offered him metal and a shop, and the men gave him a hand now and then. Yet they were not truly social in the Earth sense: they lived apart, spoke little, and watched Harry's struggle with calm detachment.

(iii) How did the life of the Bitterings change finally? Was it better or worse?

Finally the Bitterings changed completely into Martians. Their skin darkened, their eyes became golden, their daughter wove tapestries and their sons played ancient flutes. They forgot the Earth settlement and laughed at its odd houses. Judged by Earth standards, the change was worse, because they lost their identity, their language and their past. Judged by their own happiness, it was not worse, because they were calm, healthy and content in their new life. The story leaves the reader to decide whether a happy loss of self is a gain or a tragedy.

(iv) Write the story in your own words.

Harry Bittering, his wife Cora and their three children land on Mars to escape the coming war on Earth. From the start Harry feels the Martian air dissolving his identity, and he wants to return. Then Laura brings the news that atom bombs have hit New York and all the rockets have blown up, so the family is stranded. Harry tries to build a rocket with Sam's metal, but the work is slow and the town's people grow calm and strange. By autumn Harry stands dark and golden-eyed, his family weaves tapestries and plays Martian flutes, and five years later a rescue rocket finds only friendly dark people with yellow eyes who have forgotten the Earth town.

(v) What are the differences in the lifestyle of the people of the two planets?

The people of Earth live busy, hurried lives full of fear, work and war, and they value speed, business and return tickets. The people of Mars, as the Bitterings become, live slow and peaceful lives: they sit in leisure, converse gently, weave tapestries, play flutes and accept nature without struggle. Earth people fight their environment, while Martian people

blend with it. The story suggests that the Martian way is calmer and happier, but it costs the Earth people their identity, their memories and their past.

Exercise 5: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 25)

(i) He (feel) his hair flutter.

He felt his hair flutter.

(ii) They (see) the old cities.

They saw the old cities.

(iii) He (look) at the hills.

He looked at the hills.

(iv) He (stumble) on the path.

He stumbled on the path.

(v) He was (drench) in fear.

He was drenched in fear.

(vi) The boards (warp) out of shape.

The boards warped out of shape.

(vii) The men (move) slowly.

The men moved slowly.

(viii) The children (appear) happy.

The children appeared happy.

(ix) They (play) songs on flutes.

They played songs on flutes.

(x) The rocket (turn) in the sky.

The rocket turned in the sky.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 25)

the towns empty but we found native life in the hills sir dark people yellow eyes martians very friendly we talked a bit not much they learn english fast

"The towns empty, but we found native life in the hills, sir. Dark people, yellow eyes, Martians, very friendly. We talked a bit, not much. They learn English fast."

Lesson 4: Thank You, M'am (Langston Hughes)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 29)

(i) The woman was carrying:

(a) a small bag

(b) a suitcase

(c) a basket

✓ (d) a large purse

(ii) From where was the woman coming?

(a) a hotel

✓ (b) a beauty shop

(c) an office

(d) a college

(iii) What had happened to her?

(a) she had lost her way

(b) she had met an old friend

(c) she had been robbed

✓ (d) a boy tried to snatch her purse

(iv) The boy washed his face on the direction of:

(a) the policeman

(b) his mother

✓ (c) the woman

(d) his teacher

(v) The boy was in his:

✓ (a) teens

(b) twenties

(c) childhood

(d) old age

(vi) What was the name of the woman?

(a) Mrs. Jones

(b) Mrs. Smith

(c) Mrs. Brown

✓ (d) Luella Bates Washington Jones

(vii) The boy was dragged into a:

(a) police station

✓ (b) kitchenette-furnished room

(c) hotel room

(d) school

(viii) What did the woman suggest to the boy to look presentable?

✓ (a) to wash his face

(b) to dress properly

(c) to polish his shoes

(d) to comb his hair

(ix) The woman cooked the food and asked the boy:

(a) to go home

(b) to wash the dishes

(c) to pay for it

✓ (d) to eat

(x) What did the boy want to say to the woman?

(a) thank you m'am

(b) sorry m'am

(c) good bye m'am

✓ (d) something other than "Thank you, m'am"

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 29)

(i) The large woman was carrying a large purse containing hammer and nails. [False]

(ii) The boy offered his help to carry the purse. [False]

(iii) The woman firmly gripped the boy by his shirt front. [True]

(iv) The woman dragged the boy to her home. [True]

(v) She asked the boy to bring some food from the store. [False]

(vi) The boy was punished by the other members of the house. [False]

(vii) The boy stole the pocketbook to buy some food. [False]

(viii) The boy was afraid of going to jail. [True]

(ix) The boy did not trust the woman not to trust him. [False]

(x) The woman advised the boy not to make the mistake of latching onto her pocketbook. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 30)

(i) At what time did the boy try to snatch the purse?

The boy tried to snatch the purse at about eleven o'clock at night, when the large woman was walking home alone.

(ii) What happened to the boy when he tried to snatch the purse?

When the boy tried to snatch the purse, its strap broke and he fell on his back on the sidewalk. The woman kicked him, gripped him by his shirt front and shook him until his teeth rattled.

(iii) What was the reaction of the woman?

The woman reacted with anger and strength: she kicked the boy, held him firmly by his shirt front, shook him hard, and then, instead of handing him to the police, dragged him home to teach him a lesson.

(iv) What was the conduct of the people when they saw the incident?

When the people saw the incident, a few of them stopped, turned to look and stood watching. No one came forward to interfere or to help, and the woman dealt with the boy herself.

(v) How did the boy look physically?

The boy was fourteen or fifteen years old, frail and willow-wild. He wore tennis shoes and blue jeans, and his face was dirty and needed washing.

(vi) What was the condition of the boy when the woman gave him a few jerks?

When the woman gave him a few jerks, the boy was frightened and

ashamed. His teeth rattled, he begged to be let go, and he realized that he had been caught by a woman stronger than himself.

(vii) Why did the woman ask the boy to wash his face?

The woman asked the boy to wash his face because it was dirty, and she wanted him to look presentable before eating. She also wanted to teach him cleanliness and self-respect, which are the first steps toward a better life.

(viii) Why did the boy not run away from the house?

The boy did not run away because he did not want to be mistrusted. The woman had shown trust in him by leaving him alone in the room, and he did not want to disappoint that trust; he also wanted the food and the ten dollars she promised him.

(ix) Why did the woman not watch the boy while preparing the dish?

The woman did not watch the boy while preparing the dish because she trusted him. She wanted him to feel trusted, so that he would learn to be trustworthy and would not run away.

(x) What was the nature of the woman's job?

The woman worked in a hotel beauty shop. She was coming home late at night from her work when the boy tried to snatch her purse.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 30)

(i) Describe the incident in your own words.

One night at about eleven o'clock, a large woman named Mrs. Luella Bates Washington Jones was walking home from her work in a hotel beauty shop when a boy of fourteen or fifteen tried to snatch her large purse. The strap broke, the boy fell on his back, and the woman kicked him, gripped his shirt front and shook him. Instead of calling the police, she dragged him to her kitchenette-furnished room, made him wash his dirty face, cooked lima beans, ham and cocoa for him, and gave him ten dollars to buy the blue suede shoes he wanted. She advised him to behave himself, and the boy left unable to say anything more than a whispered thanks.

(ii) What was the effect of the woman's behaviour on the boy?

The woman's behaviour changed the boy completely. Her punishment in the street frightened him, but her kindness at home touched his heart. She fed him, trusted him and gave him money for the shoes he had wanted to steal, without asking anything in return. He felt ashamed of his act and grateful for her trust, and he did not run away even when he had the chance. In the end he could not even find words to thank her, which shows that her lesson of kindness had gone deeper than any punishment could have gone.

(iii) Why did the woman treat the boy nicely at home after punishing him in the street?

The woman treated the boy nicely at home because she understood his

poverty and his past. She told him that she too had done things in her youth of which she was not proud, and she knew that punishment alone would not reform him. By feeding him, trusting him and giving him money for his shoes, she showed him that kindness and respect can change a person. Her aim was not revenge but reform: she wanted him to learn right from wrong and to grow into an honest man.

Exercise 5: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 31)

(i) She (carry) a large purse.

She carried a large purse.

(ii) He (fall) on his back.

He fell on his back.

(iii) People (turn) to look.

People turned to look.

(iv) She (drag) the boy home.

She dragged the boy home.

(v) He (get) up.

He got up.

(vi) She (take) him to her room.

She took him to her room.

(vii) She (make) him wash his face.

She made him wash his face.

(viii) He (stay) in the room.

He stayed in the room.

(ix) She (lead) him to the door.

She led him to the door.

(x) He (want) blue suede shoes.

He wanted blue suede shoes.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 31)

well you didnt have to snatch my pocketbook to get some suede shoes said mrs luella bates washington jones you could have asked me

"Well, you didn't have to snatch my pocketbook to get some suede shoes," said Mrs. Luella Bates Washington Jones. "You could have asked me."

Exercise 7: Use the following prepositions in your own sentences: in, across, off, up, around (Book p. 31)

Use 'in' in a sentence of your own.

The boy put his hands in his pockets when the woman caught him.

Use 'across' in a sentence of your own.

The woman carried her purse slung across her shoulder.

Use 'off' in a sentence of your own.

The boy took his hat off when he entered the room.

Use 'up' in a sentence of your own.

The woman picked the boy up when he fell on the sidewalk.

Use 'around' in a sentence of your own.

A few people stood around watching the incident.

Lesson 5: The Piece of String (Guy de Maupassant)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 35)

(i) The rich people had gathered at a big ball:

(a) to watch a show

(b) for a discussion

(c) to hear a lecture

✓ (d) for a great meal

(ii) What was the public statement made by the drumbeater?

✓ (a) the loss of a black leather pocketbook containing money and business papers

(b) the loss of a gold watch

(c) the loss of a horse

(d) the loss of a piece of string

(iii) Hubert was surprised and disturbed when the police officer asked him to accompany him to:

(a) the police station

✓ (b) the mayor's office

(c) the court

(d) the market

(iv) "By my word of honour I never heard of it" means:

(a) he never saw it

✓ (b) he never heard of the lost object

(c) he was an honourable man

(d) he never thought of picking it up

(v) What did Hubert say in the most exasperating tone?

(a) I never stole the pocketbook

(b) I picked up a piece of string

✓ (c) it is, nevertheless, the truth of the good God, the sacred truth

(d) O, him! Yes! He saw me pick up this string here

(vi) How did Hubert feel when he was informed of the recovery of the lost object?

(a) disgusted

✓ (b) triumphed

(c) indifferent

(d) concerned

(vii) "But he only met with incredulity" means he was believed to be:

(a) telling the truth

✓ (b) lying

(c) showing faith

(d) a gentleman

(viii) What did the people say behind his back?

✓ (a) those are lame excuses

(b) he is innocent

(c) he is unreliable

(d) he is a man of loose character

(ix) What did Hubert feel at the people's disbelief?

(a) the grace of his personality

✓ (b) shame and disgrace to his self-esteem and character

(c) that he was truthful

(d) that he was trustworthy

(x) What were the last words Hubert uttered before his death?

✓ (a) "a piece of string! a piece of string!"

(b) "I am innocent!"

(c) "God is my witness!"

(d) "Forgive me!"

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 35)

(i) Everybody's mouth was watered on the sight of wealth. [True]

(ii) The finder of the pocketbook will be rewarded. [True]

(iii) He drew out the little pocketbook from his pocket. [False]

(iv) Mr. Hubert was pleased to hear the allegation. [False]

(v) The people greeted Hubert warmly when he came out of the office of the Mayor. [False]

(vi) George found the pocketbook and gave it to Hubert. [False]

(vii) The people believed the reason Hubert gave to prove his innocence. [False]

(viii) The people started to tell the story of the string to amuse themselves. [True]

(ix) A great flood carried away the people. [False]

(x) Nothing but the flood proved Hubert's innocence. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 36)

(i) Why did Manana accuse Hubert of picking up the lost pocketbook?

Manana accused Hubert because he had seen Hubert pick up something from the ground in the market-place and thought it was the lost pocketbook. There was also old enmity between the two men, which made Manana ready to believe the worst of Hubert.

(ii) What did the people think of Hubert when they heard of the return of the pocketbook by some other person?

Even after the pocketbook was returned by another person, the people still did not believe Hubert. They thought he had an accomplice who returned it for him, or that he himself had returned it secretly, and they continued to mock his story of the string.

(iii) Why did George give the pocketbook to his employer?

George gave the pocketbook to his employer because he was Manana's servant and had found it honestly. As a faithful workman, he returned what he had found to his master instead of keeping it.

(iv) What made Hubert feel shameful?

Hubert felt shameful because the people refused to believe his innocence and laughed at him everywhere. The constant mockery wounded his honour and self-respect, which mattered more to him than wealth or comfort.

(v) Why did the people make fun of his innocence?

The people made fun of his innocence because they were suspicious,

jealous and fond of gossip. They enjoyed repeating the story of the string for amusement, and they thought his simple explanation was only a lame excuse to hide his guilt.

(vi) Why did he keep claiming his innocence before his death?

He kept claiming his innocence because his honour was dearer to him than life itself. He wanted his name cleared before the world, and the false accusation tormented him day and night until it finally killed him.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 36)

(i) Write a note on the character of Hubert.

Hubert, or Hauchecorne, is an honest but proud Norman peasant. He is thrifty enough to pick up a piece of string from the road, yet innocent of the theft of which he is accused. He is simple and truthful, and he believes that truth will always win. But he is also proud and sensitive about his honour, so the people's mockery wounds him deeply. Instead of ignoring the gossip, he repeats his explanation everywhere until it becomes an obsession. His tragedy is that his virtues, honesty and self-respect, become the cause of his ruin when a suspicious world refuses to believe him.

(ii) Write ten lines on the mentality of the people who did not believe Hubert.

The people who did not believe Hubert show a suspicious and gossip-loving mentality. They judge by appearances and enjoy a scandal

more than the truth. Once Manana accuses Hubert, they accept the charge without proof and repeat it for fun. Even the return of the pocketbook does not change their minds; they invent a new excuse, that Hubert had an accomplice. They value a clever story over justice, and they never think of the pain they cause. Their mentality is that of a crowd which follows rumour blindly and crushes an innocent man for amusement.

(iii) Why did the Mayor not believe in the innocence of Hubert?

The Mayor did not believe Hubert because Manana's accusation seemed supported by what Manana had seen: Hubert bending down and picking something up in the market-place. The Mayor, like the crowd, found the story of the string too simple to be true, and he suspected that Hubert was hiding his guilt behind a clever excuse. Even when the pocketbook was returned, the Mayor thought Hubert had arranged its return through another person, so his suspicion remained.

(iv) Was it necessary for Hubert to continue pleading his innocence?

For Hubert's peace of mind it seemed necessary, because his honour was at stake and he could not bear to be called a thief. Yet his constant pleading was also harmful: it kept the story alive, gave people fresh chances to mock him, and wore down his health until he died. A wiser course would have been to live quietly and let his honest life prove his innocence. But Hubert was a proud man, and for such a man silence before a false charge feels like an admission of guilt.

(v) What suggestions would you give to Hubert to save him from this humiliating situation?

I would suggest that Hubert stop repeating his story to everyone, because every repetition gave the mockers new material. He should have demanded that Manana prove the charge or apologize, and asked the Mayor to announce his innocence publicly when the pocketbook was returned. He should have kept his dignity, worked hard, and let time and his honest conduct silence the gossip. If the village still mocked him, he could have moved to another village for a fresh start instead of letting shame eat away his life.

Exercise 5: Fill in the blanks with suitable prepositions: on, to, of, at, from (Book p. 36)

(i) He was walking ___ the public square.

to

(ii) He pretended to be looking ___ something ___ the ground.

at, on

(iii) They had decided ___ purchase.

on

(iv) The finder is requested ___ return the same.

to

(v) George claimed ___ have found the pocketbook.

to

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 37)

i was seen with the pocketbook who saw me mr manana the harness man saw you pick up the pocketbook

"I was seen with the pocketbook! Who saw me? Mr. Manana, the harness man, saw you pick up the pocketbook."

Exercise 7: Use the following words in your own sentences (Book p. 37)

Use 'purchase' in a sentence of your own.

Hubert went to the market to purchase a few things for his house.

Use 'attentive' in a sentence of your own.

The Mayor was attentive to every word of Manana's accusation.

Use 'surprised' in a sentence of your own.

Hubert was surprised when the officer asked him to come to the Mayor's office.

Use 'astounded' in a sentence of your own.

The people were astounded to hear that the pocketbook had been found.

Use 'shook' in a sentence of your own.

Hubert shook his head when the people refused to believe him.

Exercise 8: Read the passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 37)

(i) Did all the people rise on hearing the sound of the drumbeat?

No, all the people did not rise. A few of them, who still had food in their hands, did not rise on hearing the drumbeat.

(ii) What was the announcement made by the drumbeater?

The drumbeater announced the loss of a black leather pocketbook containing five hundred shillings and some business papers, lost on the road between nine and ten in the morning. The finder was requested to return it to the Mayor's office or to Mr. James, the caretaker, and would receive twenty shillings as a reward.

(iii) Who was the owner of the lost pocketbook?

The passage does not name the owner of the pocketbook. It only says that the finder should return it to the Mayor's office or to Mr. James, the caretaker of the public hall.

(iv) Where was the pocketbook lost?

The pocketbook was lost on the road, between nine and ten in the morning, on the way to the market.

Lesson 6: The Reward (Lord Dunsany)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 41)

(i) Jorkens said that a man who wanted to succeed had to be:

(a) an athlete

✓ (b) a determined person

(c) a lucky person

(d) a hardworking person

(ii) The man who keeps on wins:

✓ (a) the reward

(b) the race

(c) the shield

(d) the trophy

(iii) He would be the skating champion of the Sahara if he really gave:

(a) some time to it

(b) a lot of money to it

✓ (c) all his time to it

(d) his youth to it

(iv) He hit on an extraordinary ambition, to be appointed:

(a) a Court musician

(b) a Court jester

(c) a Court singer

✓ (d) a Court acrobat

(v) At sixteen he won:

(a) the long jump

(b) the high jump only

(c) the hundred yards only

✓ (d) the high jump, the hurdles and the hundred yards

(vi) Gorgios probably wanted to:

(a) make his country powerful

✓ (b) prove his parents wrong

(c) wear a splendid uniform

(d) create the post of Court acrobat

(vii) When Gorgios was inaugurated, the people applauded because he:

✓ (a) had achieved his ambition

(b) looked splendid

(c) performed well

(d) defeated his enemies

(viii) The great throne-room was turned into a:

(a) courtroom

✓ (b) gymnasium

(c) theatre

(d) museum

(ix) Terbut:

✓ (a) asked Jorkens what his own ambition was

(b) believed Jorkens

(c) disagreed with Jorkens at first

(d) improved Jorkens' argument

(x) Gorgios achieved his ambition by:

(a) building a skating-rink

✓ (b) going into politics

(c) getting an opportunity

(d) winning the hundred yards

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 41)

(i) They talked of money and determination at the Club. [False]

(ii) Gorgios wanted to prove his parents wrong. [True]

(iii) He went into politics to persuade them. [True]

(iv) The creation of the post of Court acrobat would increase the glory of the country. [True]

(v) It would inspire them to win the just rights of the nation. [True]

(vi) Many athletes competed for the post of Court acrobat. [False]

(vii) The magnificent uniform of Gorgios impressed them all. [True]

(viii) Everyone was sad on the inauguration. [False]

(ix) The band played softly. [True]

(x) Gorgios looked up with a slightly sad expression towards the royal platform. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions in one or two sentences (Book p. 42)

(i) What was the subject discussed at the Club?

The subject discussed at the Club was opportunity and determination: whether opportunity or determination is required for success in life.

(ii) What did Terbut think of Jorkens' argument?

Terbut disagreed with Jorkens' argument. He believed that opportunity, and not determination alone, was needed for success, and he argued that Gorgios was born a good athlete.

(iii) How did Jorkens convince the people that a man can become the skating champion of the Sahara?

Jorkens argued that if a man is determined, sticks to his aim and gives all his time to it, he can even make the money to reach the Sahara, build a skating-rink there and become its champion.

(iv) How did Gorgios persuade his people to make his country strong?

Gorgios went into politics and preached that the glory of the country and its ancient throne would increase if the post of Court acrobat were created. He taught the people that a young athlete at Court, exhibiting

perfect physical fitness, would strengthen the soldiers and enable the nation to win its just rights in battle.

(v) What was the viewpoint of the parents of Gorgios?

The parents of Gorgios probably held the same view as the Club members: that success requires opportunity, and that his ambition to become a Court acrobat, a post which did not even exist, was a wild and impossible idea.

(vi) What were the arrangements for the inauguration function?

The great throne-room was turned into a gymnasium, with the Royal House seated on a raised platform and the principal officers standing beside and behind them. Red and gold curtains hung along the walls, high swings with gilded ropes hung from the ceiling, neat hurdles stood on the polished floor, and a band in pale green and gold played softly.

(vii) Describe the scene of the inauguration in five sentences.

When the doors opened with a flood of golden light, the old man appeared in his brilliant red velvet uniform with gold buttons and lace. His white hair and the red uniform showed each other off to perfection, and his thin, aged figure looked melancholy in the tight-fitting dress. He walked slowly in his pointed shoes, leaning on a gilded stick, towards the hurdles over which he had once won an easy victory. As he looked up with a slightly sad expression towards the royal platform, gentle applause broke out from every hand. He bowed, was led to a seat, and his life's ambition was achieved at last.

(viii) What were the feelings of Gorgios on the occasion of his

inauguration?

Gorgios felt proud that his life's ambition was achieved at last, but also slightly sad and melancholy. He was an old, thin man worn by age and by more than sixty years of patience, and the glory came to him only when he could no longer perform as an athlete.

(ix) Did Gorgios use any short cut to achieve his ambition?

No, Gorgios used no short cut at all. He stuck to his wild idea for more than sixty years, went into politics, wore down all opposition, and waited until the post was duly created.

(x) How long had Gorgios to stick to his ambition to get it achieved?

Gorgios had to stick to his ambition for more than sixty years, from the time he was sixteen until he was an old man at his inauguration.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 42)

(i) What were the political views of Jorkens?

Jorkens believed that determination, not opportunity, decides success in every field, including politics. He held that a man who sticks to one idea hard enough and long enough will get what he wants, even if the post he wants does not exist. Gorgios proved this by going into politics, preaching his idea year after year, wearing down opposition, and finally getting the post of Court acrobat created. For Jorkens, politics was simply another race in which the man who keeps on wins.

(ii) How did Gorgios achieve his ambition?

Gorgios achieved his ambition by sticking to it for more than sixty years. At sixteen he was a good athlete who hit on the wild idea of becoming a Court acrobat, although no such post existed. He went into politics, made speeches, preached that a Court acrobat would increase the glory of the country and strengthen its soldiers, and slowly wore down all opposition. At last the idea caught on, the post was duly created, and when an athlete had to be chosen, no one but Gorgios, who had worked for it all those years, could be appointed.

(iii) Do you agree or disagree with the viewpoint of the writer? Give five reasons.

I agree with the writer's viewpoint that determination wins. First, history shows that great achievers stuck to their aims through failure. Second, opportunity alone is useless without the will to use it. Third, determination creates its own opportunities, as Gorgios created his post. Fourth, most people fail because they tire and sit down, not because they lack chances. Fifth, even a wild idea can succeed if a person refuses to abandon it for a lifetime.

(iv) Why were the brilliant dresses put in the shade at the inauguration?

The brilliant dresses of the ladies and the uniforms of the officers were put in the shade because Gorgios's own uniform outshone them all. His tight-fitting suit of red velvet, gay with gold buttons and shining lines of gold lace, and his white hair against the red, made a splendid sight. More than that, the moment itself was supreme: an old man's lifelong ambition was being crowned, and nothing else in the hall could match the glory of that achievement.

(v) What lesson does the story teach?

The story teaches that determination and patience win the reward in the end. A man who keeps on, without tiring or turning to something else, will achieve even an impossible-looking ambition. It also teaches that there is no short cut to real success: Gorgios waited more than sixty years and never gave up his one idea. Finally, it warns that success may come late, when the joy of it is mixed with sadness, yet it is still worth the struggle.

Exercise 5: Join the phrase in Column I with the relevant phrase in Column II (Book p. 43)

Some said opportunity was —

required for success.

He was a good athlete when —

he came by his wild idea.

He went into them harder —

than anyone else.

He had power enough to preach his —

ambition openly.

He had only to stick for a —

few more days to that wild idea.

I used to do in those days when —

food used to be cheap.

His white hair and red uniform —

showed each other off to perfection.

It must have taken him more —

than sixty years to do it.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 43)

life is like a race jorkens went on in which they tire after a while and sit down or get interested in something else instead the man who keeps on wins the race

"Life is like a race," Jorkens went on, "in which they tire after a while and sit down or get interested in something else instead. The man who keeps on wins the race."

Exercise 7: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 43)

(i) He (be) determined, (stick) to his idea and (get) the post.

He was determined, stuck to his idea and got the post.

(ii) He (want) to be a Court acrobat and (could) (make) the country glorious.

He wanted to be a Court acrobat and could make the country glorious.

(iii) He (be) a good athlete and (give) speeches.

He was a good athlete and gave speeches.

(iv) He (be) old and his hair (be) white.

He was old and his hair were white.

(v) He (could) (make) the soldiers strong.

He could make the soldiers strong.

Exercise 8: Use the following phrasal verbs in your sentences (Book p. 43)

Use 'get in' in a sentence of your own.

Gorgios got in the habit of preaching his ambition openly.

Use 'get out' in a sentence of your own.

The old man got out of his seat when his name was called.

Use 'get on' in a sentence of your own.

Gorgios got on with his work in politics year after year.

Use 'get off' in a sentence of your own.

The rider got off his horse at the gate of the palace.

Exercise 9: Read the passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 43)

(a) Who joined politics?

Gorgios joined politics.

(b) How can the glory of the country be increased?

The glory of the country can be increased by creating the post of Court acrobat at the Court.

(c) How was the post of Court acrobat created?

Gorgios went into politics, preached his idea openly, gave examples of other and greater Courts, and wore down all opposition over many years until the idea caught on and the post was duly created.

(d) What is the main idea of the passage?

The main idea of the passage is that determination and sticking to one idea can create even what does not exist, and that a man who keeps on wins his reward in the end.

Lesson 7: The Use of Force (William Carlos Williams)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 47)

(i) Who is 'I' in the story?

(a) the father

✓ (b) the doctor

(c) the mother

(d) the sick child

(ii) The parents were nervous because:

(a) they did not want to tell the doctor anything

✓ (b) they did not know what to say

(c) they wanted the doctor to tell them everything

(d) the child did not tell anything

(iii) The doctor was impressed:

✓ (a) by the beauty of the child

(b) by the patience of the child

(c) by the patience of the parents

(d) by the picture of the child he had seen in Sunday's paper

(iv) The doctor took a 'trial shot of it' means:

✓ (a) he made a wild guess to begin with

(b) he gave her a shot (injection)

(c) he took the parents to task

(d) he examined her carefully

(v) The doctor feared that the child might suffer from diphtheria because:

(a) from her appearance

(b) her parents told him

(c) from his examination

✓ (d) he guessed because there had been such cases in the local school

(vi) The child did not respond to the doctor's instructions because:

(a) she was afraid of the doctor

✓ (b) she was a stubborn child

(c) her parents tried to open her mouth

(d) she was angry with the doctor

(vii) The doctor ground his teeth in anger because:

(a) the child did not respond to his instructions

(b) the mother told the girl that he would not hurt her

✓ (c) the parents did not let him handle the child

(d) the child knocked his glasses off

(viii) The doctor had almost succeeded in opening her mouth but failed to see her throat because:

(a) the child resisted strongly

✓ (b) the parental love made the father release her at the last moment

(c) the rough handling hurt the child

(d) the mother stopped him

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 47)

(i) The story is about a sick child. [True]

(ii) The parents took the child to the doctor. [False]

(iii) The doctor was impressed by the innocent beauty of the child. [True]

(iv) The doctor thinks the girl may suffer from diphtheria. [True]

(v) The doctor makes a guess because there have been some diphtheria cases in the local schools. [True]

(vi) The girl refuses to open her mouth for examination. [True]

(vii) The parents joined the doctor in opening her mouth. [True]

(viii) They succeeded in opening her mouth. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 48)

(i) What was the condition of the parents on the arrival of the doctor?

On the arrival of the doctor, the parents were nervous, anxious and apologetic. They did not know what to say, and they were worried about their sick child who had had a fever for three days.

(ii) What was the behaviour of the child with the doctor?

The child behaved coldly and stubbornly with the doctor. She stared at him with cold, steady eyes, refused to answer his questions, and would not open her mouth for examination.

(iii) She had a fever for three days, hadn't she?

Yes, she had had a fever for three days, and her parents feared that she might be suffering from diphtheria.

(iv) Did the girl change her expression when the doctor said, "Does your throat hurt you?"

No, the girl did not change her expression at all, nor did she move her eyes from the doctor's face when he asked whether her throat hurt her.

(v) Why did the doctor call the sick girl by her first name?

The doctor called the sick girl by her first name to win her confidence and to coax her gently into cooperating with the examination.

(vi) Did the sick girl promptly respond to the instructions of the doctor?

No, the sick girl did not respond at all to the doctor's instructions. She remained silent and stubborn, and refused to open her mouth.

(vii) Why did the parents rebuke the girl?

The parents rebuked the girl because she would not answer the doctor and would not cooperate with the examination. They were embarrassed by her stubborn behaviour before the doctor.

(viii) What was the threat of the doctor to the child if she did not show her throat?

The doctor threatened the child that if she did not open her mouth by herself, they would have to open it for her. He said, "Will you open it now by yourself or shall we have to open it for you?"

(ix) Why did she break the wooden blade?

She broke the wooden blade because she was fighting desperately to prevent the examination. When the doctor got the wooden spatula behind her last teeth, she gripped the blade between her molars and

reduced it to splinters.

(x) What was the condition of the tonsils of the sick girl?

Both tonsils of the sick girl were covered with a membrane, which confirmed that she was suffering from diphtheria. She had been hiding her sore throat for three days to escape examination.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 48)

(i) How did the child look by appearance?

The child was a beautiful girl with cold, steady eyes that seemed to eat the doctor up. She sat in her father's lap in the kitchen, staring silently at the doctor without moving her eyes from his face. Her expression did not change even when spoken to, and she looked strong and defiant rather than weak or frightened. The doctor was impressed by her innocent beauty, but also by the stubborn strength with which she resisted him.

(ii) Why did the parents keep the sick child in the kitchen?

The parents kept the sick child in the kitchen because it was the warmest and most comfortable room of the house, and because the family spent most of its time there. They could watch over her, keep her warm near the stove, and attend to her needs while doing their household work.

(iii) How did the doctor succeed in examining her throat?

The doctor succeeded only by using force in a final, unreasoning assault. He overpowered the child's neck and jaws, forced a heavy silver spoon

back of her teeth and down her throat until she gagged, and then saw both tonsils covered with membrane. The examination, which gentleness and coaxing had failed to achieve, was thus completed, and the diagnosis of diphtheria was confirmed.

(iv) What were the feelings of the doctor in his struggle to diagnose the child?

The doctor's feelings passed from gentleness to anger and fury. He began kindly, coaxing the child and trying to win her trust, but her stubborn resistance made him grind his teeth and grow furious, even at a child. At the same time he felt the pressure of professional duty, because he knew that without a diagnosis the child might die. After forcing the examination, he felt shame at his own fury, mixed with relief that the truth was known.

(v) Compare and contrast the conduct of a healthy child with that of a sick child.

A healthy child is usually cheerful, talkative and ready to cooperate with others, and it answers questions and follows instructions willingly. A sick child, like the girl in the story, is often silent, fearful and stubborn; it refuses to answer, resists examination and clings to its parents. The healthy child trusts the doctor, while the sick child sees him as a threat. Yet both need patience and kindness, and the sick child needs even more understanding because its resistance comes from fear and pain.

(vi) Under what circumstances can the use of force be justified?

The use of force can be justified only when it is necessary to save a life or to prevent serious harm, and when gentleness has failed. A doctor

may use force to examine a child who cannot understand the danger of its illness, as in this story, where diphtheria could have killed the girl. Force is justified when it is used with a good purpose, in reasonable measure, and not in anger or revenge. It must always be the last resort, never the first.

Exercise 5: Write down the correct form of the verb (Book p. 49)

(i) When I (arrive), I (meet) my mother.

When I arrived, I met my mother.

(ii) I (motion) for him not to bother.

I motioned for him not to bother.

(iii) I (move) my chair a little nearer.

I moved my chair a little nearer.

(iv) She (knock) my glasses flying and they (fall).

She knocked my glasses flying and they fell.

(v) I (explain) the danger.

I explained the danger.

(vi) They (grow) more and more and (crush) the blade.

They grew more and more and crushed the blade.

(vii) Then she (shriek) terrifyingly.

Then she shrieked terrifyingly.

(viii) Then I (grasp) the child's head with my left hand.

Then I grasped the child's head with my left hand.

(ix) She (open) up her mouth for an instant.

She opened up her mouth for an instant.

(x) She (reduce) it to splinters before I (can) get it out again.

She reduced it to splinters before I could get it out again.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 49)

does your throat hurt you added the mother to the child but the little girls expression didnt change nor did she move her eyes from my face

"Does your throat hurt you?" added the mother to the child, but the little girl's expression didn't change, nor did she move her eyes from my face.

Exercise 7: Use the following words in your own sentences (Book p. 49)

Use 'start' in a sentence of your own.

The doctor had to start the examination all over again.

Use 'motion' in a sentence of your own.

The mother made a motion for the child to sit still.

Use 'trust' in a sentence of your own.

The sick child had no trust in the strange doctor.

Use 'magnificent' in a sentence of your own.

The doctor was impressed by the magnificent courage of the little girl.

Use 'leaflet' in a sentence of your own.

The health department gave the parents a leaflet about diphtheria.

Exercise 8: Fill in the blanks (Book p. 50)

(i) I mentioned it ___ her.

to

(ii) It was ___ me to tell them.

up to

(iii) I took a trial shot ___ it.

at

(iv) We were all quite thinking ___ that.

of

(v) I haven't anything ___ my hands.

in

Exercise 9: Use the following phrasal verbs in your sentences (Book p. 50)

Use 'sit on' in a sentence of your own.

The sick child sat on her father's lap during the examination.

Use 'sit in' in a sentence of your own.

The doctor sat in a chair near the child.

Use 'come from' in a sentence of your own.

The doctor had come from his clinic to visit the child.

Use 'come off' in a sentence of your own.

The handle of the spoon came off during the struggle.

Exercise 10: Answer the questions given at the end of the paragraph (Book p. 50)

(i) Why did the doctor become furious?

The doctor became furious because the child fought desperately with clenched teeth and refused to let him examine her throat. His professional pride was hurt, and his anger at being defeated by a child made him lose his temper.

(ii) What instrument did the doctor use to open her mouth?

The doctor used a wooden tongue depressor, or spatula, to open her mouth, and later a heavy silver spoon.

(iii) Why did she grip the wooden blade between her molars?

She gripped the wooden blade between her molars to prevent the doctor from seeing her throat. She was fighting with all her strength to keep her secret, the sore throat she had hidden for three days.

(iv) Write down the main idea of the paragraph.

The main idea of the paragraph is the doctor's fierce struggle to examine a stubborn sick child's throat. It shows how his anger and his sense of duty drove him to use force, and how the examination at last revealed the membrane on her tonsils.

Lesson 8: The Gulistan of Sa'di (Sheikh Sa'di)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 53)

(i) The slave had never experienced any:

(a) pleasure

✓ (b) calamity

(c) rule

(d) war

(ii) The boat started tossing means that the boat:

(a) remained peaceful

(b) started flying

✓ (c) started shaking

(d) sank

(iii) The slave began to cry and tremble:

(a) in joy of getting a reward

✓ (b) in fear of being drowned

(c) by seeing others crying

(d) by the punishment inflicted by the king

(iv) The slave was thrown into the water:

(a) to catch a fish

(b) to drink water

✓ (c) to experience the true danger of life

(d) to swim

(v) Who was Nushirvan?

(a) a merchant of Persia

(b) a soldier of Persia

(c) a poet of Persia

✓ (d) a king of Persia

(vi) The king was famous for:

(a) cruelty

✓ (b) justice

(c) wisdom

(d) wealth

(vii) "The foundation of oppression was small in the world" means:

(a) the condition of being ruled unjustly was found in the world

(b) the foundation of the building was small

✓ (c) the oppression was not deep rooted

(d) little cruelty in the world

(viii) The king fell seriously ill and all hopes of his recovery:

(a) were enlightened

✓ (b) went out of existence

(c) were expected

(d) faded

(ix) For what purpose did the parents give their consent to kill their son?

(a) for reputation

✓ (b) for money

(c) to get rid of a naughty boy

(d) to escape their duty

(x) On hearing the words of the boy, the king could not control his:

(a) anger

(b) laughter

(c) hunger

✓ (d) tears

(xi) The boy saved his life by praying to:

(a) the king

(b) the Qazi

(c) his parents

✓ (d) God Almighty

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 54)

(i) A Persian slave was not sailing in the king's boat. [False]

(ii) The slave was used to voyaging. [False]

(iii) All the passengers remained quiet except the slave. [True]

(iv) He was pacified by the sergeant. [True]

(v) The king punished the sergeant for throwing the slave into the water. [False]

(vi) The king of Persia was famous for his justice. [True]

(vii) The boy paid the price of the salt. [True]

(viii) The king got the consent of the parents by giving them a huge amount of wealth. [True]

(ix) The boy looked towards the king and smiled. [False]

(x) The king shed the blood of the innocent boy. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 55)

(i) What was the advice given by Nushirvan to his people?

Nushirvan advised his people to pay for even the smallest thing, lest injustice become a custom and ruin the village. He taught that the foundation of oppression is small in the world, but whoever enlarges it is at fault: if a king eats one apple from a subject's garden by force, his slaves will pull down the whole tree.

(ii) What was the remedy suggested by the physicians for the king's disease?

The physicians suggested that the king's disease could be cured only by means of the bile of a person endowed with certain qualities. Orders were therefore issued to search for such an individual, and a farmer's son was found to possess those qualities.

(iii) Why did the boy look towards the sky and smile?

The boy looked towards the sky and smiled because he had no refuge left on earth. His parents had sold him for wealth, the Qazi had issued a decree to kill him, and the king had ordered his death, so he turned to God Almighty alone and said that he saw no other refuge besides Him.

(iv) What should be the role of a Qazi?

The role of a Qazi should be to do justice and to protect the innocent. He should hear the complaints of the oppressed against the powerful, and he should never issue a decree to shed innocent blood merely to please a king.

(v) Why did the king weep on hearing the words of the boy?

The king wept because the boy's words pierced his heart. He realized his own cruelty in ordering the death of an innocent boy whose only fault was that his bile might cure him, and he said that it was better for him to die than to shed the blood of an innocent boy.

(vi) How did the king recover from his disease?

The king recovered within a week after sparing the boy's life. He kissed the boy's head and eyes, presented him with a lot of wealth, and gave up the cruel cure; by the mercy of God and by his own repentance, his health was restored without any bloodshed.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 55)

(i) Write a note on the character of Nushirvan.

Nushirvan was a king of Persia famous for his justice. He was wise and careful even in trifling matters: when a boy brought him salt without paying for it, he ordered the boy to pay, lest injustice become a custom and ruin the village. He understood that oppression begins with small acts and grows when rulers enlarge it. His justice was not harsh but thoughtful, and it protected the weak against the powerful. That is why his name became a symbol of just rule in Persian literature.

(ii) What should be the role of a king?

The role of a king should be to protect his people and to do justice to all, rich and poor alike. He should not take anything by force, even a trifle,

because his example is followed by his officers and soldiers. He should listen to the complaints of the oppressed, punish the cruel, and show mercy to the innocent. A good king makes his people prosperous and happy, while an unjust king brings trouble and ruin upon his country.

(iii) Can an unjust king flourish in the world?

No, an unjust king cannot flourish in the world. As Sa'di says, a tyrant does not remain in the world, but the curse on him abides for ever. His oppression may seem successful for a time, but it breeds hatred, rebellion and ruin. The people suffer, the country decays, and history remembers him only with curses. Justice alone gives a ruler lasting fame, while cruelty destroys both the king and his kingdom.

(iv) What is the moral lesson of the second tale?

The moral lesson of the second tale is that injustice begins with small acts and must be stopped at the start. Nushirvan made the boy pay for the salt because a trifling wrong, if allowed, becomes a custom and grows into great oppression. It also teaches rulers that they will be held responsible for the wrongs their servants commit in their name. A just ruler must therefore be careful even in the smallest matters.

(v) Compare and contrast the three tales of the lesson.

The three tales all teach the value of justice and mercy, but in different ways. The first tale shows that a man does not value safety until he has tasted danger, as the slave learned only after being thrown into the sea. The second tale shows that oppression begins small and must be checked by a just king. The third tale shows that even a king's life is not worth an innocent boy's blood, and that mercy cures what cruelty

cannot. Together they teach that justice, mercy and gratitude are the foundations of good rule.

(vi) Describe an event in which the trouble of one person affects others.

In the first tale, the trouble of one person, the Persian slave, affected all the passengers in the boat. His crying and trembling in fear of drowning created inconvenience for everyone and displeased even the king. In daily life the same thing happens: one person's carelessness in a family, a classroom or a village disturbs the peace of all. That is why Sa'di teaches that every person should control himself and think of others, because no trouble remains private for long.

Exercise 5: Fill in the blanks with suitable words: by, of, at, to, in, more, through, for (Book p. 56)

(i) The slave had never been ___ sea.

to

(ii) The others tried to pacify him ___ kindness.

through

(iii) A man does not realize the worth ___ safety.

of

(iv) A boy was sent to a village ___ bring salt.

to

(v) The foundation of oppression was small ___ the world.

in

(vi) The more the disease was cured the ___ it became painful.

more

(vii) Why do you laugh ___ such a position?

at

(viii) The parents have agreed to get my blood shed ___ the trash of this world.

for

(ix) He will recover his health only ___ my slaying.

through

(x) The king presented a lot ___ wealth.

of

Exercise 6: Use the following words in your own sentences (Book p. 56)

Use 'calamity' in a sentence of your own.

The slave had never faced any calamity before his voyage.

Use 'inconvenience' in a sentence of your own.

The slave's crying caused great inconvenience to the passengers.

Use 'permission' in a sentence of your own.

The sergeant asked the king's permission to quieten the slave.

Use 'drowned' in a sentence of your own.

The slave feared that he would be drowned in the sea.

Use 'enlarge' in a sentence of your own.

Whoever enlarges a small wrong is at fault, said the king.

Use 'executioner' in a sentence of your own.

The executioner was directed to slaughter the boy.

Exercise 7: Use the following phrasal verbs in your sentences (Book p. 56)

Use 'hit by' in a sentence of your own.

The boat was hit by a storm during the voyage.

Use 'hit upon' in a sentence of your own.

The physicians hit upon a strange cure for the king's disease.

Use 'ask for' in a sentence of your own.

The boy asked for justice from God alone.

Use 'ask after' in a sentence of your own.

The king asked after the health of his people every day.

Exercise 8: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 56)

if they fail they are expected to bring the case before the qazi to seek justice but in the present case the parents have agreed to get my bloodshed for the trash of this world

"If they fail, they are expected to bring the case before the Qazi to seek justice. But in the present case, the parents have agreed to get my bloodshed for the trash of this world."

Exercise 9: Read the passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 56)

(1) What was the cure suggested by the physicians for the ailment of the king?

The physicians suggested that the king's disease could be cured only by means of the bile of a person endowed with certain qualities.

(2) How did the king get the consent of the parents of the boy?

The king got the consent of the parents by giving them a huge amount of wealth.

(3) Why did the Qazi issue a decree to shed the blood of a boy?

The Qazi issued the decree because the king's health was thought to require the boy's blood, and the law was bent to serve the king's life.

(4) Why did the boy look toward the sky?

The boy looked toward the sky because he had no helper left on earth: his parents had sold him, the Qazi had decreed his death, and the king had ordered it, so only God could help him.

(5) Give the main idea of the passage.

The main idea of the passage is that only God is the refuge of the oppressed, and that mercy and justice are greater than power. A king who spares an innocent life finds his own cure, while cruelty brings only disgrace.

Lesson 9: The Foolish Quack

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 59)

(i) Where did the travellers stay?

(a) in an inn

(b) in a jungle

(c) in a haveli

✓ (d) under a clump of trees

(ii) Why did the camel fall ill?

(a) by heat stroke

(b) by infection

✓ (c) when a melon stuck in its throat

(d) by poison

(iii) What did a quack claim to cure?

(a) fever

✓ (b) goiter

(c) headache

(d) injury

(iv) What had happened to the throat of an old woman?

(a) infectious

✓ (b) swollen

(c) wounded

(d) paining

(v) What punishment did the villagers propose on the death of the old woman?

(a) to pay the damages

(b) to be persecuted

✓ (c) to dig her grave

(d) to be imprisoned

(vi) How was the quack treated when he had dug the grave?

(a) honoured

(b) rewarded

✓ (c) beaten well

(d) fined

(vii) What was the effect of punishment on the quack?

✓ (a) uninfluenced

(b) influenced

(c) left the profession

(d) returned disgusted

(viii) What was the condition the quack suggested before treating an old man?

(a) to lay the old man on the bed

✓ (b) not to be compelled to dig the grave

(c) not to be made responsible for the death of the man

(d) to have the fee first

(ix) Why did the quack return to the camel-men instead of continuing his profession?

(a) to befool them

(b) to enquire the cause of death of an old woman

(c) to blame them

✓ (d) to get his luggage

(x) Who was proved stupid?

(a) the camel-men

(b) the old woman

✓ (c) the quack

(d) a villager

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 60)

(i) With the blow of the mallet the melon broke in the throat of the camel.

[True]

(ii) The camel swallowed the broken melon and felt all right. [True]

(iii) The quack cured the old woman. [False]

(iv) The quack was compelled to dig the grave. [True]

(v) The villagers of the next village refused to get the old man treated. [True]

(vi) The quack returned to the camel-men to tell them that they had shown the right way to cure the disease. [False]

(vii) The camel can bear the blow of a mallet but not the old man. [True]

(viii) There was little effect of the blow of a whip on the camel. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 60)

(i) What is a clump of trees?

A clump of trees is a group of trees growing close together in one place.

(ii) What was stuck in the camel's throat?

A melon was stuck in the camel's throat, and the animal fell ill because of it.

(iii) What did the quack pretend to cure?

The quack pretended to cure goiter, the swelling of the throat.

(iv) What did the quack do with the old woman?

The quack struck the old woman's swollen throat with a mallet, just as he had seen the camel-men do to the camel, and killed her.

(v) What was the result of the cure?

The result of the cure was the death of the old woman.

(vi) What was the punishment inflicted upon the quack by the villagers?

The villagers compelled the quack to dig the old woman's grave himself, and when he had dug it, they beat him well.

(vii) For whom did the quack dig the grave?

The quack dug the grave for the old woman whom his treatment had killed.

(viii) What did the quack do in the next village?

In the next village the quack offered to cure an old man suffering from goiter, on the condition that he would not be compelled to dig the grave.

(ix) Why didn't the villagers let the old man get cured?

The villagers did not let the old man get cured because they knew that the quack's treatment had killed the old woman. They feared that the old man would die in the same way.

(x) Why did the quack come back to the camel-men?

The quack came back to the camel-men to get his luggage, which he had left with them.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 60)

(i) How did the camel-men cure their camel?

The camel-men cured their camel by a rough but effective method. When a melon stuck in the camel's throat, one of them struck the animal's throat with a heavy mallet. The blow broke the melon, the camel swallowed the broken pieces and felt all right. The camel was strong enough to bear the blow, so the crude treatment worked in its case.

(ii) How did the quack try to cure the old woman?

The quack tried to cure the old woman by copying the camel-men blindly. He tied up the woman's throat and struck her swollen throat with a mallet, believing that what had cured the camel would cure her goiter. But a human throat is delicate, and the blow killed the old woman instead of curing her.

(iii) How did the quack come to realize his error?

The quack came to realize his error only after punishment and failure. The villagers made him dig the old woman's grave and beat him well, and in the next village the people refused to let him treat an old man. Finally, when a camel-man struck him with the same blow that had felled the old man, he understood that a treatment fit for a camel is not fit for a human being.

(iv) How did the camel-man prove the stupidity of the quack?

The camel-man proved the quack's stupidity by a practical

demonstration. He struck the camel with a heavy stick bound with iron rings, and the animal scarcely felt the blow and merely moved a step or two. Then he struck a man with a similar blow, and the man fell to the earth like a log. This showed the quack that what is good for camels is not therefore good for poor old men and women.

(v) What lesson does the story teach?

The story teaches that a remedy must suit the patient, and that blind imitation is dangerous. The quack copied a treatment without understanding it, and his ignorance killed a woman. It also teaches that a person who pretends to knowledge he does not possess will be exposed and punished. True wisdom lies in knowing the limits of one's knowledge and in treating human beings with care, not with the rough methods used for animals.

Exercise 5: Use the correct form of the verb (Book p. 61)

(i) Some travellers (stay) to rest under a clump of trees.

Some travellers stayed to rest under a clump of trees.

(ii) The owner (see) this and (fear) to lose the animal.

The owner saw this and feared to lose the animal.

(iii) A man (look) on and (observe) the proceeding.

A man looked on and observed the proceeding.

(iv) He (tie) up the woman's throat.

He tied up the woman's throat.

(v) They (seize) him to carry him before the king.

They seized him to carry him before the king.

(vi) The man (labour) away with all his might.

The man laboured away with all his might.

(vii) He (finish) his task and (bury) the victim.

He finished his task and buried the victim.

(viii) The man (mount) his camel and (go) to the next village.

The man mounted his camel and went to the next village.

(ix) I (meet) an old woman who (suffer) from goitre.

I met an old woman who suffered from goitre.

(x) When consciousness (return), his bewildered victim (inquire).

When consciousness returned, his bewildered victim inquired.

Exercise 6: Use the following phrasal verbs in your sentences (Book p. 61)

Use 'break in' in a sentence of your own.

The thief tried to break in through the window at night.

Use 'break out' in a sentence of your own.

A fire broke out in the village last night.

Use 'break off' in a sentence of your own.

The speaker had to break off his speech when the crowd shouted.

Use 'break down' in a sentence of your own.

The old cart broke down on the way to the market.

Exercise 7: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 61)

do you not perceive answered the camel-man i wished to show you that what is good for camels is not therefore good for poor old men and women

"Do you not perceive?" answered the camel-man. "I wished to show you that what is good for camels is not therefore good for poor old men and women."

Exercise 8: Read the passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 61)

(i) Who addressed the newcomer?

One of the camel-men addressed the newcomer.

(ii) With what did he strike the camel and what was the effect of it?

He struck the camel with a heavy stick bound with iron rings. The stolid creature scarcely felt the blow and merely moved a step or two forward.

(iii) What was the effect of the same act on the man?

The same blow struck the man down to the earth like a log, and when consciousness returned he asked why he had been treated so cruelly.

(iv) What lesson do you get from the passage?

The lesson of the passage is that what is good for animals is not necessarily good for human beings. A treatment must suit the patient, and blind imitation of a crude remedy can be fatal.

Lesson 10: A Mild Attack of Locusts (Doris Lessing)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 64)

(i) Why did the cookboy run?

(a) to kill the insects

(b) to summon the labourers

✓ (c) to inform the landlady

(d) to see the locusts

(ii) Why did the houseboy run off to the store?

(a) to shut the door

(b) to cover the store

✓ (c) to collect any bit of metal

(d) to burn fire

(iii) Why did they throw wet leaves onto the fire?

✓ (a) to make the smoke acrid and black

(b) to extinguish the fire

(c) to burn the leaves

(d) to burn the insects

(iv) "And they neither went bankrupt nor got very rich" means that they were:

(a) hand to mouth

✓ (b) just pulling on their lives

(c) enjoying a moderate living

(d) penniless

(v) How did the locusts attack the crops?

(a) one by one

(b) in groups

✓ (c) in swarms

(d) in formations

(vi) Why did the people beat the tin cans?

(a) to let the insects enjoy music

✓ (b) to keep the insects away

(c) to kill the insects

(d) to fill the cans with insects

(vii) What did the farmers do at the time of attack?

(a) they ran away from the place

✓ (b) they took precautionary measures to keep the locusts away

(c) they covered their crops

(d) they shut themselves in their houses

(viii) Locusts attack in the area of:

(a) one mile

(b) ten miles

✓ (c) fifty miles

(d) hundred miles

(ix) What made the boughs of trees weighed to the ground?

(a) fruit

✓ (b) locusts

(c) birds

(d) wind storm

(x) How did the land look after the locusts had moved to the south?

(a) all green

(b) barren

(c) beautiful

✓ (d) a devastated landscape

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 65)

(i) The servants looked happy. [False]

(ii) The old ploughshare was hanging. [True]

(iii) There were eleven patches of bared soil. [False]

(iv) The locusts were coming slowly. [False]

(v) The earth seemed to be motionless. [False]

(vi) The insects are heavy with eggs. [True]

(vii) Margaret preferred to think of the locusts. [False]

(viii) Everything was saved. [False]

(ix) There was not a blade of grass left on the farm. [True]

(x) Locusts were going to be like bad weather. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 65)

(i) What are locusts?

Locusts are large grasshoppers which move in huge swarms and destroy every green thing in their path. They are a natural calamity for farmers.

(ii) Why did the farmers throw wet leaves on the fire?

The farmers threw wet leaves on the fire to make the smoke thick, acrid and black, so that it would drive the locusts away from their fields.

(iii) What was the desire of every farmer?

The desire of every farmer was that the locusts would overlook his farm and go on to the next. Each farmer hoped his neighbour's farm would be

attacked instead of his own.

(iv) Did Margaret know what to do to keep the locusts away?

No, Margaret did not know what to do to keep the locusts away. She was wondering what she could do to help, and old Stephen had to explain the plan to her.

(v) What was the condition of the trees?

The trees were queer and still, clotted with insects, and their boughs were weighed to the ground by the weight of the locusts.

(vi) How did old Stephen treat the stray locust which he found on his shirt?

Old Stephen picked the stray locust off his shirt and split it down with his thumbnail. It was clotted inside with eggs, which showed that the swarm was looking for a place to settle and lay.

(vii) Are the hoppers different from the locusts?

No, the hoppers are not different from the locusts: they are young locusts which cannot yet fly. If the swarm laid its eggs, the farm would later be eaten flat by hoppers.

(viii) Did Margaret lose heart on the loss of crops?

No, Margaret did not lose heart. She remained calm and endured what she could not cure, and she tried to get used to the idea of years of locusts, like bad weather.

(ix) Why are the locusts compared with bad weather?

The locusts are compared with bad weather because, like bad weather, they are a natural calamity which cannot be prevented by man. Farmers must endure them, replant their fields, and hope for better times, just as they endure storms and droughts.

(x) Why did the men eat their supper with good appetites?

The men ate their supper with good appetites because they had done their best all day, they were tired with hard work, and they felt that it could have been worse. They accepted the loss calmly and were relieved that the worst had passed.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 66)

(i) How did the farmers try to prevent the main swarm of locusts from landing on their farms?

The farmers tried to prevent the main swarm from landing by making big fires all around the farmlands and throwing wet leaves on them to make the smoke acrid and black. They beat old ploughshares, tin cans and gongs, and shouted loudly to frighten the insects away. Labourers poured out of the compound and ran about beating metal, while the farmers hoped that with enough smoke and noise till sunset, the swarm would settle somewhere else.

(ii) Why, even after all the crops were destroyed, did the men continue to fight the swarm?

The men continued to fight the swarm even after the crops were

destroyed because the main swarm had not yet settled. The insects were heavy with eggs and were looking for a place to lay them. If they settled on the farm, the eggs would hatch into hoppers which would eat everything flat later on. So the fight was no longer for the present crop but for the future, to save the farm from a worse attack.

(iii) What was the condition of the land when the locusts had moved to the south?

When the locusts had moved to the south, the land was a devastated landscape. There was not a blade of grass left on the farm, the trees were bare, the fields were stripped of every crop, and everything, trees, buildings, bushes and earth, was gone under the moving brown masses. The farm looked like a battlefield after a war, and the family felt like survivors of a disaster.

(iv) What are the measures the farmers should have taken to save their crops? Give five suggestions.

The farmers should have taken these measures: first, they should have kept a watch for the coming swarm and warned their neighbours early; second, they should have prepared fires and smoke in advance; third, they should have dug trenches and pits to trap the insects; fourth, they should have used sprays and chemicals to kill the locusts; and fifth, they should have planted resistant crops and insured their harvest against such calamities.

(v) Write a note on the character of Margaret.

Margaret is a brave and sensible woman. At first she does not know what to do against the locusts, and she wonders how she can help. But she

soon learns to face the calamity with calm and patience. She does not lose heart when the crops are destroyed, and she accepts the loss like bad weather. She thinks of the future, of replanting and of rain, and she encourages the men by her quiet courage. Her character shows that endurance is as important as action in the face of nature's fury.

Exercise 5: Write down the correct form of the verb in each sentence (Book p. 66)

(i) Stephen (yell) at the house boy.

Stephen yelled at the house boy.

(ii) Margaret (see) the smoke of fire rising all around.

Margaret saw the smoke of fire rising all around.

(iii) Old Smith had (has) his crops eaten to the ground.

Old Smith had had his crops eaten to the ground.

(iv) The sunlight (come) down distorted.

The sunlight came down distorted.

(v) The earth (seem) to be moving.

The earth seemed to be moving.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 66)

all the crops finished nothing left he said but the gongs were still beating the men still shouting and margaret asked why do you go on with it then

"All the crops finished, nothing left," he said, "but the gongs were still beating, the men still shouting, and Margaret asked, 'Why do you go on with it, then?'"

Exercise 7: Fill in the blanks by using the preposition given in the bracket: at, on, off, in, over (Book p. 66)

(i) They could see the labourers pointing ___ the hills.

at

(ii) Every farmer hoped the locusts would go ___ to the next.

on

(iii) The main swarm showed ___ dense black cloud.

in

(iv) Those beggars can eat every leaf ___ the farm.

off

(v) A tree down the slope leaned ___ the ground.

over

Exercise 8: Read the following passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 66)

(i) Why did Margaret wonder?

Margaret wondered what she could do to help against the locusts. She did not know how to fight the swarm, and she felt helpless while the men worked.

(ii) What did old Stephen say?

Old Stephen said, "We're finished, Margaret, finished! Those beggars can eat every leaf and blade off the farm in half an hour! And it is only early afternoon: if we can make enough smoke, make enough noise till the sun goes down, they'll settle somewhere else perhaps."

(iii) What did he desire?

Old Stephen desired that they should keep up enough smoke and noise till the sun went down, so that the locusts would settle somewhere else. He also desired a cup of tea, saying, "Get the kettle going. It's thirsty work, this."

Lesson 11: I Have a Dream (Martin Luther King, Jr.)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 69)

(i) "You have come here out of great trials and tribulations" means that you have come after:

(a) attending a fair

✓ (b) facing great persecutions and grief

(c) great honour

(d) great travels

(ii) "You have been the veterans of creative suffering" means that you have been the:

✓ (a) experienced soldiers of intellectual suffering

(b) assets of a nation

(c) vanguard of a country

(d) army personnel

(iii) This nation will live out the true meaning of its creed:

(a) Negroes will leave the country

✓ (b) they will come up to the level of others

(c) they will prove their worth

(d) they will remain a minority

(iv) What is the dream?

✓ (a) equality of high and low

(b) rule of the blacks

(c) freedom of the whites

(d) wealth of the nation

(v) Which one is a desert state sweltering with the heat of injustice and oppression?

(a) Georgia

✓ (b) Mississippi

(c) Alabama

(d) Virginia

(vi) What does the governor of Alabama do?

(a) creates interferences

✓ (b) makes interruptions

(c) uses sweet words

(d) helps the blacks

(vii) What will be exalted?

(a) hill

(b) mountain

✓ (c) valley

(d) river

(viii) "Every hill and mountain shall be made low" means that:

✓ (a) all high and low will become equal

(b) hills and mountains will be levelled

(c) there will be no distinction of classes

(d) the low classes will rise up

(ix) The glory of whom shall be revealed?

(a) President

(b) Governor

✓ (c) Lord

(d) Mayor

(x) What is the beautiful symphony of brotherhood?

(a) a violin

(b) a guitar

(c) the beautiful song of brotherhood

(d) musical composition of brotherhood

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 70)

(i) Some of you have come from the areas where you lived happily.

[False]

(ii) Stop working with the faith that un-earned suffering is redemptive.

[False]

(iii) Let us not wallow in the valley of despair. [True]

(iv) It is a dream deeply rooted in the American dream. [True]

(v) Son of a slave will live with the son of a slave owner. [True]

(vi) In future every hill and mountain shall be made low. [True]

(vii) A stone of hope is a coal. [False]

(viii) My country is a sweet land of liberty. [True]

(ix) My country is not a pride of pilgrims. [False]

(x) All the people, black and white, are treated equally. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 70)

(i) What was the cause of the Negroes' discontentment?

The cause of the Negroes' discontentment was racial discrimination. Although slavery had ended a hundred years earlier, the Negroes were still denied freedom, justice and equal rights, and they lived as exiles in their own land.

(ii) What are the qualities of the veterans of creative suffering?

The veterans of creative suffering are those who have suffered without bitterness and without hatred. They have continued to work with the faith that unearned suffering is redemptive, and they have faced trials, jail cells and persecutions with discipline and hope.

(iii) What is the dream of Martin Luther King, Jr.?

The dream of Martin Luther King, Jr. is that one day his children will live in a nation where they will not be judged by the colour of their skin but by the content of their character. He dreams of freedom, equality and brotherhood for all the people of America, black and white together.

(iv) What should be the faith of the Negroes?

The faith of the Negroes should be that unearned suffering is redemptive, and that freedom and justice will surely come. They should keep working with this faith and should not wallow in the valley of despair.

(v) What was the necessity of pleading the case of the Negroes' freedom?

It was necessary to plead the case of the Negroes' freedom because the Negroes were still not free. A hundred years after emancipation, they were still languishing in the corners of American society, and the promise of democracy had not been fulfilled for them.

(vi) What should be the criterion of judgment for a person?

The criterion of judgment for a person should be the content of his character, and not the colour of his skin.

(vii) Do the Negroes enjoy liberty in all the parts of their country?

No, the Negroes do not enjoy liberty in all parts of their country. In states like Alabama and Mississippi they faced segregation, oppression and the interposition of governors who blocked their rights.

(viii) From which part of the country did the Negroes gather there?

The Negroes gathered there from all parts of the country: from Mississippi and Alabama, from Georgia and the narrow jail cells of the South, and from every corner of America where they had suffered.

(ix) Write down the song in your own words.

The song says: My country, it is of you, sweet land of liberty, that I sing. It is the land where my fathers died and the land of the pilgrims' pride. From every mountainside, let freedom ring: from the prodigious hilltops of New Hampshire, the mighty mountains of New York, the heightening Alleghenies of Pennsylvania, the snow-capped Rockies of Colorado, and the curvaceous slopes of California.

(x) What is the effect of the repetition of words?

The repetition of words creates emphasis, rhythm and emotional force. Phrases like "I have a dream" and "let freedom ring" repeated again and again make the speech memorable, stir the hearts of the listeners, and drive the message of freedom deep into their minds.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 71)

(i) Write a note on the struggle of Martin Luther King, Jr. for the Negroes.

Martin Luther King, Jr. led a peaceful struggle for the freedom and equality of the Negroes in America. He organized marches, protests and civil rights campaigns, and he taught his followers to suffer without bitterness and without violence. He was jailed many times, yet he never gave up his faith that unearned suffering is redemptive. His famous speech "I Have a Dream", delivered before the Lincoln Memorial, became the voice of the movement. He dreamed of a nation where all men, black and white, would join hands as brothers, and his struggle changed the laws and the conscience of America.

(ii) What was the condition of the Negroes in his days?

In King's days the Negroes lived in a sad condition. A hundred years after emancipation, they were still not free: they were segregated in schools, buses and public places, denied the right to vote in many states, and treated as second-class citizens. Many lived in ghettos, worked for low wages, and suffered police violence and the hatred of white extremists. Their life was still sadly crippled by the manacles of segregation and the

chains of discrimination, and that is why they rose to demand their rights.

(iii) Write ten lines on racial discrimination.

Racial discrimination is the unjust treatment of people because of the colour of their skin. It divides society into high and low, and denies equal rights to those who are dark. It appears in schools, jobs, housing and public places, and it breeds hatred and bitterness. It is against the principles of democracy, which hold that all men are created equal. It wastes human talent and weakens a nation. It can only be removed by just laws, by education, and by teaching children to judge others by character and not by colour. A society free from discrimination is a society at peace with itself.

(iv) Write the summary of the speech.

In his speech, Martin Luther King, Jr. reminds America that a hundred years after emancipation the Negro is still not free. He says that the time has come to make real the promise of democracy, and he urges his followers to struggle with discipline and faith, without bitterness or violence. He then paints his dream: that one day the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will sit together at the table of brotherhood, that his children will be judged by the content of their character, and that freedom will ring from every hill and mountain of America until all God's children, black and white, join hands.

(v) What are the measures you can take to ensure justice with all the sections of the society?

To ensure justice with all sections of society, we should treat every

person equally, without regard to colour, caste or creed. We should support just laws and oppose discrimination wherever we see it. We should give equal opportunities in education and employment to the poor and the weak. We should teach children tolerance and respect for others, and we should settle disputes by dialogue and not by force. Above all, we should judge every person by the content of his character, as King taught, and work for a society in which freedom rings for all.

Exercise 5: Join the phrase in Column I with the relevant phrase in Column II (Book p. 71)

It came as a joyous daybreak —
to end the long night of captivity.

The life of the Negroes is still —
sadly crippled.

This note was a promise that all —
men would be guaranteed the rights.

Now is the time to make —
real the promise of democracy.

In the process of gaining our —
rightful place we must not do wrongs.

There are those who are asking —

the devotees of civil rights.

Some of you have come —

fresh from narrow jail cells.

It is a dream deeply —

rooted in the American dream.

We will be able to hew out —

of the mountain of despair.

When all the children of God —

will be able to join hands.

Exercise 6: Use the correct form of the verb given in brackets (Book p. 71)

(i) The architects of our republic (write) the magnificent words.

The architects of our republic wrote the magnificent words.

(ii) All men (guarantee) the unalienable rights of life.

All men are guaranteed the unalienable rights of life.

(iii) We (come) to this hallowed spot.

We have come to this hallowed spot.

(iv) Continue (work) with the faith.

Continue working with the faith.

(v) Former slave owners (sit) down together.

Former slave owners sit down together.

(vi) Every valley (exalt) to see my dream (realize).

Every valley shall be exalted to see my dream realized.

(vii) We (be) free one day.

We shall be free one day.

(viii) Let freedom (ring) from the mighty mountains.

Let freedom ring from the mighty mountains.

(ix) The black men and white men (join) hands.

The black men and white men join hands.

(x) This selection (design) as an oration.

This selection is designed as an oration.

Exercise 7: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 71)

i have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed we hold these truths to be self evident that all men are created equal

"I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: 'We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all

men are created equal.'"

Lesson 12: The Gift of the Magi (O. Henry)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 76)

(i) James Dillingham Young had two valuable things:

(a) a house and a car

(b) a necklace and a clock

(c) TV and VCR

✓ (d) Jim's gold watch and Della's hair

(ii) Della's hair was more beautiful than any:

(a) painting

(b) palace

✓ (c) queen's jewels and gifts

(d) scene

(iii) Della's hair reached below her:

(a) neck

(b) back

(c) feet

✓ (d) knees

(iv) "Down fell the brown waterfall" means:

(a) the stream flowed down

(b) the brown waterfall fell down

✓ (c) Della's hair fell down

(d) the brown water fell down

(v) What did she buy for Jim?

(a) a watch

✓ (b) a gold watch chain

(c) a necktie

(d) a shirt

(vi) What was common in Jim and the watch chain?

(a) simplicity

(b) quietness

(c) value

✓ (d) quietness and value

(vii) With her short hair, she looked wonderfully like a:

(a) young girl

✓ (b) school boy

(c) dame

(d) woman

(viii) What did Della pray?

✓ (a) may he think her still pretty

(b) may she live long

(c) may she have long hair again

(d) may she remain pretty

(ix) No one can count Della's:

(a) feelings

✓ (b) love

(c) hair

(d) jewels

(x) Jim bought a gift of:

(a) a watch

(b) shoes

(c) clips

✓ (d) the combs

Exercise 2: Mark the sentences true or false (Book p. 77)

(i) The gold watch belonged to Jim's father. [True]

(ii) Jim knew that no king had anything so valuable as the gold watch. [True]

(iii) Della sold her hair for twenty dollars. [True]

(iv) For three hours she seemed to fly from shop to shop to find a gift. [False]

(v) She could not do anything with a dollar and eighty-seven cents. [True]

(vi) Jim took his dinner at eight. [False]

(vii) Jim was paid 20 dollars a week. [True]

(viii) Both couldn't live through Christmas without exchanging gifts. [True]

(ix) She refused to have the gift of the combs. [False]

(x) The gifts were too nice to use on Christmas. [True]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 77)

(i) How much did she save for Christmas?

She saved only one dollar and eighty-seven cents for Christmas.

(ii) Why did she feel proud in the beauty of her hair?

She felt proud in the beauty of her hair because it was long, shining and more beautiful than any queen's jewels and gifts. It fell below her knees and almost made itself into a dress for her, and it was her greatest treasure.

(iii) Why did she sell her hair?

She sold her hair to buy a Christmas gift for Jim. She had no money except one dollar and eighty-seven cents, and she wanted to give him something worthy of him, so she sold her most precious possession.

(iv) Why did Jim sell the gold watch?

Jim sold the gold watch to buy a Christmas gift for Della. He wanted to give her the beautiful combs she had longed for, and he had no other

money to buy them.

(v) Why did they want to exchange the gifts?

They wanted to exchange gifts because they loved each other deeply and could not think of celebrating Christmas without presenting gifts. Their love made them sacrifice their most valuable things for each other.

(vi) Why did she feel sad on losing her hair?

She felt sad on losing her hair because her beauty seemed to go with it. She feared that Jim would no longer think her pretty, and she prayed that he might still think her pretty even with short hair.

(vii) Why did Jim not welcome her when he stepped in?

Jim did not welcome her at once because he was stunned and speechless at seeing her short hair. He stood inside the door, looking at her with a strange expression which she could not understand, and he seemed unable to believe what had happened.

(viii) What did he bring out of his coat?

He brought out of his coat a package tied in paper, containing the combs: beautiful combs with jewels, perfect for her beautiful hair, which Della had seen in a shop window and longed for.

(ix) How beautiful was the gold watch chain?

The gold watch chain was very beautiful in its simplicity. It was plain and simple, with quietness and value, and its value lay in its rich and pure material. It was good enough for the watch, just as Jim was quiet and valuable himself.

(x) What was the wisdom in selling the most valuable things?

The wisdom in selling the most valuable things was that love is more valuable than any material possession. Della and Jim proved that true giving means sacrifice, and that is why, of all who give and receive gifts, they are the wisest, like the Magi.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 50-100 words (Book p. 78)

(i) How did the Magi want to celebrate their Christmas?

The Magi, the wise men of the East, wanted to celebrate the first Christmas by bringing gifts to the newborn Christ-child. Being wise, their gifts were doubtlessly wise too. In the same spirit, Della and Jim wanted to celebrate their Christmas by exchanging gifts, even though they were poor. Their celebration was not about the price of the gifts but about the love behind them, and that is why their Christmas became the wisest of all.

(ii) How much were they attached to each other in the story?

Della and Jim were attached to each other with the deepest love. Each of them owned only one precious thing, her hair and his watch, and each sold that treasure to buy a gift for the other. They did not think of themselves at all, only of making the other happy at Christmas. Such attachment, which sacrifices everything for love, is rare, and it makes them the wisest givers in the story.

(iii) Why did they sell their beautiful valuable things?

They sold their beautiful valuable things because they were poor and had no other money to buy Christmas gifts. Della had only one dollar and eighty-seven cents, and Jim's pay had fallen to twenty dollars a week. Yet they could not bear a Christmas without gifts, so each sold the most precious possession. Their sacrifice shows that love does not count the cost, and that a gift given with sacrifice is worth more than gold.

(iv) Describe the story in your own words.

Della and Jim Young are a poor young couple who love each other deeply. Della has only one dollar and eighty-seven cents to buy a Christmas gift for Jim, so she sells her long, beautiful hair for twenty dollars and buys a gold watch chain for his precious watch. Jim, in turn, sells his gold watch to buy the beautiful jewelled combs Della has longed for. On Christmas Eve they discover that each gift is useless without the treasure that was sold to buy it, yet their sacrifice proves them the wisest of all givers, like the Magi.

(v) What is the moral of the story?

The moral of the story is that the value of a gift lies in the love and sacrifice behind it, not in its price. Della and Jim gave up their most precious possessions for each other, and their gifts, though useless in use, were priceless in love. True wisdom is not in keeping one's treasures but in giving them for the happiness of a loved one. That is why the author calls them the Magi: of all who give and receive gifts, they are the wisest.

Exercise 5: Connect part of Column I with the relevant part of Column II (Book p. 78)

She had had many happy hours —

planning something nice for him.

It had once belonged —

to his father.

It almost made itself —

into a dress for her.

She stood still while —

a tear or two ran down her face.

Take your hat off and let —

me look at it.

Its value was in its —

rich and pure material.

She hurried home with —

the chain and eighty-seven cents.

He simply looked at her with that —

strange expression on his face.

Exercise 6: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 78)

i want you to understand me dell he said nothing like a haircut could make me careless for you but if you ll open that you may know what i felt when i came in

"I want you to understand me, Dell," he said. "Nothing like a haircut could make me careless for you. But if you'll open that, you may know what I felt when I came in."

Exercise 7: Read the passage and answer the questions given at the end (Book p. 78)

(i) Who were the wise men?

The wise men were the Magi, who brought gifts to the newborn Christ-child.

(ii) Who were the first to give Christmas gifts?

The Magi were the first to give Christmas gifts.

(iii) Were these two the wisest?

Yes, of all who give gifts, these two, Della and Jim, were the wisest, because they sacrificed their most valuable things out of love.

(iv) Write the main idea of the passage.

The main idea of the passage is that true love and selfless sacrifice make one wise. The value of a gift is not in its price but in the love with which it is given, and Della and Jim are therefore the wisest of all givers.

Lesson 13: God be Praised (Ahmad Nadeem Qasmi)

Exercise 1: Answer the following questions (Book p. 85)

(i) What was alias Abul's full name?

Alias Abul's full name was Maulvi Abul Barkat. He was a pious and kind-hearted village Maulvi, known to everyone simply as Abul.

(ii) What was his turban known as and where did it originally come from?

His turban was known as the Mashadi lungi. It was light brown in colour, and it originally came from Mashad, a city in Iran.

(iii) What did he always carry with him?

He always carried with him a walking stick, a sort of scepter with decorative bands of brass and gilt. It was a mark of his dignity.

(iv) Describe Maulvi's appearance.

Maulvi Abul was an impressive old man. His eyes were slightly bulging, he wore silver rings set with large turquoise stones, his hair at the temples was silvery white, and his teeth were loose. His voice was resonant, though sometimes it quivered, and he used fragrant oil for his hair.

(v) How much did the Maulvi collect on every Eid?

On every Eid the Maulvi collected 150 to 200 rupees in his cotton bag from the devotees. People gave him money gladly because they

respected his piety and his charity.

(vi) How much was distributed among the needy and the poor?

Forty to fifty rupees were distributed among the needy and the poor. He kept only a small part for himself and gave away the rest with his own hands.

(vii) What was the name of his eldest daughter?

The name of his eldest daughter was Mehrunnisa, called Mehrun. Her marriage was an important event in the story.

(viii) What was the name of the member of the District Board where the Maulvi lived?

The member of the District Board where the Maulvi lived was Chaudhry Fateh Dad. He was an influential man of the village and a friend of Maulvi Abul.

(ix) What was the name of his wife?

The name of his wife was Zaibunnisa. She was the mother of Arif, and she managed the house and supported her husband in his charitable work.

(x) Write the names of the other two daughters mentioned in the story.

The other two daughters mentioned in the story are Zabda and Shamsun. Zabda is the second daughter, and Shamsun, the third daughter, came forward slowly when her father called her.

Exercise 2: Read the lesson and tick the correct word (Book p. 86)

(i) Maulvi Abul had slightly (slanting, bulging, drooping) eyes.

(a) slanting

✓ (b) bulging

(c) drooping

(ii) He wore (silver, gold, platinum) rings with large stones.

✓ (a) silver

(b) gold

(c) platinum

(iii) His cotton bag contained 150 to (100, 200, 300) rupees collected from the devotees.

(a) 100

✓ (b) 200

(c) 300

(iv) The name of his first born child was (Zebunnisa, Mehrunnisa, Lutufunnisa).

(a) Zebunnisa

✓ (b) Mehrunnisa

(c) Lutufunnisa

(v) Ch. Fateh Dad was member of the District (Council, Board, Bar).

(a) Council

✓ (b) Board

(c) Bar

(vi) Shamim Ahmed was the (eldest, youngest, only) son of a Haafiz.

(a) eldest

(b) youngest

✓ (c) only

(vii) Maulvi Abul had saved (33, 43, 53) rupees only.

(a) 33

✓ (b) 43

(c) 53

(viii) The seven yards of silk that Shamim measured for Maulvi Abul was for (142, 42, 420) rupees.

(a) 142

✓ (b) 42

(c) 420

(ix) A few months after Mehrunnisa's marriage a (secondary, middle, primary) school was opened in the village.

(a) secondary

(b) middle

✓ (c) primary

(x) All these years Maulvi Abul had (one, two, three) sources of inspiration.

(a) one

✓ (b) two

(c) three

Lesson 14: Overcoat (Ghulam Abbas)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book pp. 91-92)

(i) What was the colour of the overcoat of the young man?

(a) It was red.

✓ (b) It was brown.

(c) It was green.

(d) It was black.

(ii) What happened when the evening advanced?

(a) The weather became pleasant.

✓ (b) The cold became more intense.

(c) The pleasant air began to blow.

(d) The sky was covered with clouds and it started raining.

(iii) What was the condition of the overcoat, which the young man was wearing?

✓ (a) It was old.

(b) It was new.

(c) It was ragged.

(d) It was full of dust.

(iv) When the young man visited the music shop what did he find?

✓ (a) There were musical instruments in the shop.

(b) There was nothing in the shop.

(c) He found many people in the shop.

(d) There were books in the shop.

(v) When the young man died in the hospital after the accident what amount of money was discovered on him?

(a) rupees 200 only

✓ (b) only six annas and a few pies

(c) nothing was found in his pocket.

(d) only rupees 51

(vi) What were the names of two nurses who were on duty in the hospital?

(a) Nasreen and Jamila

✓ (b) Shehnaz and Gill

(c) Zakia and Surraya

(d) Zahida and Kausar

(vii) What was the owner of the shop wearing on his head?

(a) a cap

✓ (b) silk turban

(c) wearing nothing

(d) a handkerchief of green colour

(viii) After accident when the driver sped away what were the words which were uttered by the passers-by?

(a) catch him

✓ (b) stop him

(c) kill him

(d) follow him

(ix) After the accident what was the state of the young man?

✓ (a) He was in a very precarious state.

(b) He was in a stable state.

(c) He was in a normal state.

(d) He bled profusely.

(x) After the accident what was the first thing removed from the body of the young man?

(a) overcoat

(b) shoes and socks

✓ (c) white silk scarf

(d) an old cotton sweater

Exercise 2: Answer the following questions (Book p. 93)

(i) What was the colour of the overcoat of the young man?

The colour of the overcoat of the young man was brown. It was old, but well cut, and the material was of good quality.

(ii) How did he look like?

He looked like a well-dressed, elegant young man. He had sleek shining hair, side burns and a thin moustache, and he wore a brown overcoat, a cream rose in his button hole, a green flat hat at a rakish angle, a white

silk scarf, and carried a short polished cane.

(iii) Why did the people come out on the Mall?

The people came out on the Mall to amuse themselves according to their means. Some went to hotels and restaurants, others to cafes and snack bars, and all enjoyed the bright lights and music of the Saturday evening.

(iv) Who were the people wearing such dress and had come on the Mall?

The people who had come on the Mall were men and women of every class and means. They wore overcoats of every kind, from astrakhan to rough military khaki, each dressed according to what he could afford.

(v) Why was the cat shivering?

The cat was shivering because of the bitter cold. As the night advanced, the cold became more intense, and even the animals on the street felt its bite.

(vi) Why did the driver of the truck speed away after the accident?

The driver of the truck sped away after the accident because he feared capture. He took advantage of the darkness and drove off quickly, lest the people should catch him and hand him over to the police.

(vii) Who took the young man to the hospital?

The passers-by took the young man to the hospital. A car was stopped, he was loaded into it, and he was carried to a nearby hospital, where the doctors and nurses discovered his real condition.

(viii) What kind of music was played in one of the restaurants?

An orchestra played foreign music in one of the restaurants, and the listeners outside enjoyed it even more than those sitting inside.

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions in not less than 100 words (Book p. 93)

(i) Give the list of articles, which were found in the coat of the young man.

The articles found in the coat of the young man were: a small black comb, a handkerchief, six annas and a few pies, a half smoked cigarette, a little diary in which the names and addresses of a few people were noted, a list of gramophone records and a few handbills. These poor belongings showed that beneath his elegant appearance he was a very poor man.

(ii) What is the moral of the story?

The moral of the story is that appearances are deceptive and that a man should not be judged by his clothes. The young man looked rich and respectable, yet he was starving and penniless. Society respects outward show and ignores inner worth, and that is a sad fault of our social life. We should look beyond dress and show kindness to the poor, whose dignity often hides their suffering.

(iii) Write a gist of the story in ten lines.

A young man, dressed elegantly in a brown overcoat, goes out on the Mall on a bitterly cold Saturday evening. He looks rich and respectable, with a rose in his button hole and a silk scarf round his neck. He strolls

among the crowds, admires the shops, and listens to the music. Suddenly a truck knocks him down and the driver speeds away in the darkness. The passers-by cry 'Stop him!' and carry the young man to a nearby hospital. There the doctors remove his clothes one by one, and his poverty is laid bare. Under the overcoat there is only a cotton sweater full of holes and a dirty vest. His pockets hold only six annas and a few pies, a comb, a diary and some handbills. The elegant young man of the Mall was, in truth, a starving beggar in disguise.

(iv) What is the theme of the story?

The theme of the story is the contrast between appearance and reality. A young man, though poor and starving, dresses elegantly to hide his poverty, and society judges him by his clothes. When he dies in an accident, the removal of his overcoat reveals his true condition. The story satirizes a society which values outward show more than inner worth, and it shows how poverty forces men to live a life of pretence.

Lesson 15: The Angel and the Author – and Others (Jerome K. Jerome)

Exercise 1: Answer the following questions (Book p. 97)

(i) At what point of journey in his dream did the author hear the throbbing sound of wings?

The author heard the throbbing sound of wings at the point when only a faint luminosity remained beneath the darkness, after the last sight of

the long line of electric lamps bordering the Embankment in London.

(ii) What time of the year was it?

It was Christmas time. The author dreamt his dream about a fortnight after Christmas, when men and women become generous quite suddenly.

(iii) What does the author like about Christmas?

The author likes that at Christmas everybody becomes good. All men and women become generous quite suddenly, lovely sentiments are expressed, and noble deeds are done everywhere, which makes Christmas a delightful season.

(iv) Write down the good deeds the author has admitted are a great joy on Christmas.

The good deeds the author admits are a great joy on Christmas are: a sweet child giving Bovril with her own dear little hands to a shivering street arab; the good old red-faced squire shovelling plum pudding to a crowd of grateful villagers; and a man borrowing a collecting box and going round doing good himself.

(v) Why are the noble deeds always a great joy for the author?

The noble deeds are always a great joy for the author because he loves to think of all the good deeds he himself has done. Recalling them gives him pleasure and comfort, and he believes that noting them down, as in a diary, would be a comfort and a joy to him.

Exercise 2: Read the story and fill in the blanks (Book p. 97)

(i) I had a ___ dream.

vexing

(ii) It was about a ___ after Christmas.

fortnight

(iii) I turned my head to see it was the ___ angel.

recording

(iv) He had a ___ look.

weary

(v) Noble ___ are always a great joy to me.

deeds

(vi) I have often thought of keeping a ___.

diary

(vii) The author told the angel of his ___ deeds.

good

(viii) The author remembered the ___ to which he sent all his old clothes.

rummage

(ix) The show was well worth the ___.

money

(x) The author had joined the ___ for a motor car.

raffle

Exercise 3: Read the lesson and tick the correct word (Book p. 98)

(i) The author had the dream about a (week, fortnight, month) after Christmas.

(a) week

✓ (b) fortnight

(c) month

(ii) It was the recording (machine, device, Angel) following the author in his dream.

(a) machine

(b) device

✓ (c) Angel

(iii) At (Easter, Christmas, New year) men and women become generous in London.

(a) Easter

✓ (b) Christmas

(c) New year

(iv) The author subscribed (ten, three, five) shillings to the fund for the unemployed.

(a) ten

(b) three

✓ (c) five

(v) He had been to (four, five, six) charity dinners.

✓ (a) four

(b) five

(c) six

(vi) The notice appeared in the (Morning, Afternoon and Evening) Post.

✓ (a) Morning

(b) Afternoon

(c) Evening

(vii) It was a (huge, large, monster) show in aid of the fund for the destitute.

(a) huge

(b) large

✓ (c) monster

(viii) The (journey, dinner, show) was well worth the money.

(a) journey

(b) dinner

✓ (c) show

(ix) There were many other (big, great, noble) deeds of the author.

(a) big

(b) great

✓ (c) noble

(x) The author sent all of his old clothes to the (annual, rummage, grand) sale.

(a) annual

✓ (b) rummage

(c) grand